



Unlocking Namibia's Potential Through Collaboration

Empowering Industries • Expanding Trade • Building Prosperity



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July 2026

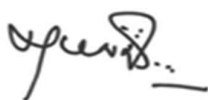
Foreword

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India has over decades, positioned itself as an institutional bridge between Indian enterprise and the world, translating diplomatic goodwill into commercial outcomes and translating commercial ambition into structured, bankable engagement. As India deepens its strategic partnership with the African continent, few relationships carry the historical weight and untapped commercial promise of the one it shares with the Republic of Namibia.

India's relationship with Namibia is unusual among India's African partnerships in that it predates Namibia's own independence. India was among the earliest nations to raise Namibia's right to self-determination at the United Nations, hosted the South West Africa People's Organisation's first diplomatic mission abroad, and contributed to the peacekeeping architecture that oversaw Namibia's transition to sovereignty. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's State Visit to Namibia in July 2025, the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister in nearly three decades, has reopened this chapter with renewed energy, and it is CCI India's conviction that the private sector must now translate that political momentum into concrete industrial, commercial and technological partnerships.

Namibia today stands at a genuinely consequential moment in its economic trajectory. It possesses globally significant reserves of uranium, and increasingly of lithium and rare earth elements that are foundational to the clean energy transition; it is emerging as one of the most credible green hydrogen production geographies in the world; it has confirmed offshore oil and gas discoveries in the Orange Basin that are attracting major international capital; and it retains a well-governed, low-corruption, politically stable operating environment that is uncommon on the continent. At the same time, Namibia faces real constraints of scale, skills, infrastructure and industrial depth that India, with its vast manufacturing base, its pharmaceutical and generics industry, its digital public infrastructure, its agricultural technology ecosystem and its pool of engineering and vocational talent, is exceptionally well positioned to help address.

CCI India commits, through this paper and the institutional roadmap it proposes, to serve as a dependable long-term partner in operationalising the India-Namibia economic relationship, one trade mission, one joint venture and one capacity-building programme at a time.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Munindra Kumar".

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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NAMIBIA

“ Experience vast deserts and wildlife, where nature’s beauty dominates.



Introduction

Namibia is a sparsely populated country located in Southern Africa with its capital at Windhoek. It is bordered by Angola, Zambia, Botswana and South Africa, and has a long coastline along the Atlantic Ocean. Namibia is known for its political stability, rich mineral resources and well-developed infrastructure compared to many African peers.

India and Namibia share warm bilateral relations, and India maintains a High Commission in Windhoek to promote diplomatic, trade and investment cooperation.

Basic Facts

The capital city of Namibia is Windhoek. The country follows a democratic republican system of government and is a member of the African Union, SADC and the Commonwealth. Namibia is globally known for the Namib Desert, one of the oldest deserts in the world, and for its strong mining sector. The country has a small population but a large land area, making it one of the least densely populated nations in Africa.

GDP (Gross Domestic Product)

Namibia’s nominal GDP is estimated to be around US\$ 13–15 billion. It is classified as an upper-middle-income economy by African standards. The country has relatively high GDP per capita compared to many African nations, though income inequality remains a challenge. Economic growth is driven mainly by mining, fishing, agriculture, tourism and services.

Trade with India (Bilateral Trade – in Billions)

Trade between India and Namibia is growing steadily. The bilateral trade between India and Namibia is estimated at approximately US\$ 0.65–0.75 billion annually. India’s exports to Namibia account for around US\$ 0.35–0.40 billion, while India’s imports from Namibia are estimated at approximately US\$ 0.30–0.35 billion. The trade relationship is relatively balanced and driven mainly by minerals and industrial goods.



“ Culture and Heritage

Namibia's culture reflects diverse ethnic groups like the Himba, Herero, and San, each with distinct traditions and crafts. Music, dance, and oral traditions play a key role in cultural expression. Its heritage is shaped by indigenous beliefs, colonial history, and Christianity, the dominant religion.

Strategic Importance & Key Observations

Namibia is strategically important for India due to its rich mineral resources, political stability and access to the Atlantic shipping routes. For India, Namibia is a key partner in uranium supply, diamond trade and mineral cooperation. There are strong opportunities for Indian companies in mining, renewable energy (especially solar and green hydrogen), fertilizers, healthcare, agriculture, food processing and infrastructure development. With growing focus on green energy and mineral value addition, Namibia offers long-term strategic and commercial potential for India.

Culture & Economic Ties with India

India and Namibia share friendly and stable relations dating back to Namibia's independence, which India actively supported. Namibia strongly supports India at international platforms and the two countries maintain close diplomatic ties. A small Indian community is present in Namibia and is actively involved in trade, retail, pharmaceuticals, hospitality and manufacturing. Namibia also participates in India's ITEC and ICCR scholarship programmes, strengthening educational, technical and institutional cooperation.

Import & Export from India

Namibia exports diamonds, uranium ore, zinc, copper, gold and hides & skins to India. Mineral resources dominate Namibia's export basket. On the other hand, India exports pharmaceuticals, rice, machinery, vehicles, refined petroleum products, iron and steel, chemicals, textiles and engineering goods to Namibia. Indian pharmaceutical products are widely used in Namibia's healthcare sector due to their affordability and quality.

Population

Namibia has a population of approximately 2.7 million people as of 2024. It is among the least densely populated countries in the world. A significant portion of the population lives in urban centers such as Windhoek, Walvis Bay and Swakopmund, while rural communities depend largely on agriculture and livestock rearing. The population is young, offering longterm potential for workforce development.



Currency

The official currency of Namibia is the Namibian Dollar (NAD), which is pegged at par with the South African Rand (ZAR). The stable linkage with the rand helps maintain currency stability and supports regional trade within Southern Africa.



About Namibia

Geography and Strategic Location

Namibia occupies approximately eight hundred and twenty-five thousand square kilometres on Africa's south-western Atlantic coast, bordered by Angola and Zambia to the north, Botswana to the east, South Africa to the south, and a fourteen-hundred-kilometre Atlantic coastline to the west. This coastline, anchored by the deepwater port of Walvis Bay and the emerging port of Lüderitz, gives Namibia a role that few landlocked or poorly connected African economies can match: that of a maritime gateway into the interior of Southern Africa, including Botswana, Zambia, the Democratic Republic of Congo and southern Angola, via the Walvis Bay Corridor network of road and rail links. For Indian exporters and investors targeting Southern African Development Community markets more broadly, Namibia's ports and logistics corridors represent an alternative to routing exclusively through South African infrastructure.

The country's defining physical characteristic is aridity. The Namib Desert, among the oldest deserts on earth, runs the length of the coast, while the Kalahari extends across the country's east. This climate constrains agricultural productivity and water security but has also endowed Namibia with some of the world's clearest skies and most striking landscapes, a combination underpinning a tourism sector built on desert, wildlife and eco-tourism experiences, and with exceptionally strong solar irradiance and coastal wind resources that are now the foundation of the country's green hydrogen ambitions.

Economic Structure

Namibia's economy, valued at approximately US\$13–15 billion with a GDP per capita of US\$5,000–5,500, was reclassified by the World Bank as a lower-middle-income economy in 2025. The services sector contributes around 55% of GDP, led by trade, financial services, public administration, and logistics through the Walvis Bay Corridor. The primary sector, dominated by mining, contributes about 21%, while manufacturing and construction account for roughly 15%.

Mining remains the backbone of Namibia's economy, contributing around 14% of GDP and nearly 46% of total exports, with uranium and metal ores being the largest export commodities. Economic growth moderated to around 1.7% in 2025 due to weaker agriculture and mining volatility but is expected to recover to 2.4–2.7% in 2026, supported by agricultural recovery, offshore oil investments, and easing interest rates. Inflation remained moderate at around 3.5%, while fiscal and current account deficits widened due to lower revenues and high imports linked to mining and energy investments.

Ease of Doing Business and Investment Climate

Namibia's business environment is characterised by a relatively small but liquid financial sector, a currency pegged one-to-one to the South African Rand within the Common Monetary Area, and a legal and regulatory framework closely modelled on, and integrated with, that of South Africa. The Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board serves as the principal one-stop investment facilitation agency, and the country offers export processing zone incentives, notably at the Walvis Bay Export Processing Zone, alongside sector-specific incentives for manufacturing and value-added mineral processing. Constraints that Indian investors should factor into market entry planning include a small domestic consumer market that necessitates an export or regional orientation for most manufacturing investments, a shallow local capital market that limits domestic co-financing options, dependence on Southern African Customs Union revenue transfers that introduces fiscal volatility, and a skills base that, while improving, remains narrow in specialised technical and vocational trades relevant to mining, energy and advanced manufacturing.

India-Namibia Relations: Historical Foundation

India and Namibia share a longstanding partnership rooted in India's early support for Namibia's independence movement. India championed Namibia's cause at the United Nations, and diplomatic relations were formally established following Namibia's independence in 1990. Since then, cooperation has expanded through capacity building under the ITEC programme, defence collaboration, and Indian-supported institutions such as the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology.

Bilateral relations gained renewed momentum with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's State Visit in July 2025, the first by an Indian Prime Minister in nearly 30 years. The visit resulted in agreements on health, entrepreneurship, digital cooperation, Namibia's accession to the Global Biofuels Alliance and the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure, and the adoption of India's Unified Payments Interface (UPI)—making Namibia the first African country to do so. While cooperation has strengthened significantly, opportunities remain to deepen collaboration in strategic sectors such as critical minerals, trade, investment, and industrial partnerships.

1. Mining & Critical Minerals

1. Sector Overview

Mining is the structural backbone of the Namibian economy and the single sector where Namibia's global relevance most exceeds its population size. The country is a top-tier global producer of uranium, one of Africa's most important diamond producers by value, and is rapidly emerging as a significant source of lithium, heavy rare earth elements, copper, zinc and gold. Namibia's mineral endowment spans almost the entirety of the critical minerals basket that underpins the global clean energy transition, electric vehicle supply chains, defence electronics and advanced manufacturing, giving the sector a strategic weight in Indian policy terms that goes well beyond ordinary commercial interest. Namibia's Ministry of Mines and Energy reported in May 2026 that mining already contributes over ten percent of GDP directly and represents more than half of total national export revenue, figures that understate the sector's true economic centrality once fiscal, foreign exchange and employment linkages are considered.

For India, whose clean energy, electronics, defence and electric mobility ambitions all depend on secure, diversified access to critical minerals currently dominated by China in processing and, increasingly, in upstream ownership as well, Namibia represents one of the more credible and politically accessible alternative sources available on the African continent. The sector overview that follows sets out the current state of Namibian mining, its structural characteristics, government priorities, the challenges Indian companies must navigate, and the specific opportunities for Indian participation across exploration, extraction, beneficiation and equipment supply.

2. Current Status

Namibia's established mining base rests on three long-operating uranium mines, Rössing, Husab and Langer Heinrich, alongside a diamond sector combining onshore Namaqualand operations with offshore marine diamond recovery in the country's exclusive economic zone. The Husab mine produced approximately four thousand four hundred tonnes of uranium in 2023 and the Rössing mine approximately two thousand two hundred tonnes, together placing Namibia among the world's three or four largest uranium-producing jurisdictions. Rio Tinto has committed to a life-extension programme at Rössing through to 2036, implying a decade of sustained capital expenditure across the pit, processing plant and supporting infrastructure. Langer Heinrich, operated by Paladin Resources, restarted production in 2024 after a six-year closure driven by depressed uranium prices, illustrating the cyclicity that Indian investors must factor into any uranium-linked commitment.

Beyond the established uranium and diamond base, Namibia is in the midst of a genuine critical minerals exploration boom. The country had approximately five hundred and eighty-eight active exploration permits on issue as of early 2026, spanning copper, lithium, rare earth elements, tin, tantalum, cobalt, graphite, nickel, niobium, vanadium and gold, concentrated substantially in the Erongo and Otjozondjupa regions. The most advanced new project is the Lofdal heavy rare earth project, a joint venture between Namibia Critical Metals and Japan's state-backed metals security agency JOGMEC, whose December 2025 pre-feasibility study modelled a nineteen percent after-tax internal rate of return, a thirteen-year mine life, and average annual production of approximately two thousand tonnes of total rare earth oxide, including roughly one hundred and nineteen tonnes of dysprosium and eighteen tonnes of terbium, two of the heavy rare earths most critical to permanent-magnet motors and most acutely subject to Chinese export restriction. Toyota Tsusho joined the Lofdal project as JOGMEC's designated strategic partner in March 2026, illustrating the level of sovereign and blue-chip industrial interest the asset has attracted.

In lithium, Andrada Mining's Uis tin-and-lithium operation is the most advanced producing asset, targeting a forty-thousand-tonne-per-year lithium concentrate output and now partnered with Chilean lithium major SQM on the adjacent Lithium Ridge resource under a staged earn-in arrangement. Several other lithium and polymetallic pegmatite projects, including Askari Metals' Uis Polymetallic Project and Xinfeng Investments' Kohero project, remain at earlier exploration stages, while the sector has also seen genuine setbacks, including the 2025 liquidation of Lepidico's Karibib lithium project, a reminder that Namibia's critical minerals story, while structurally strong, is not without commercial risk and requires careful project-level due diligence rather than blanket enthusiasm.

Indicator	Value
Mining contribution to GDP (2025)	Approximately 14 percent (over 10 percent per Ministry of Mines, May 2026)
Mining share of national exports	More than 50 percent
Ores and minerals share of 2024 exports	Approximately 46 percent
Active exploration permits (early 2026)	Approximately 588
Husab mine uranium output (2023)	Approximately 4,437 tonnes
Rössing mine uranium output (2023)	Approximately 2,205 tonnes
Lofdal HREE project reserve base	32 million tonnes at 0.176% TREO; 13-year mine life
Rio Tinto Rössing life-extension horizon	To 2036

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's mining industry is structured around a small number of large, internationally owned operating mines alongside a much larger population of junior exploration companies. Rio Tinto (Rössing), Paladin Resources (Langer Heinrich), the Sinomine-run Tsumeb smelter, and a consortium of diamond operations under NamDeb, the joint venture between the Namibian government and De Beers, anchor the producing end of the sector. The exploration and development pipeline is dominated by Australian, Canadian and increasingly Japanese and Chinese-linked juniors and strategic investors, including Namibia Critical Metals, Andrada Mining, Askari Metals and Xinfeng Investment, with financing structures typically involving staged earn-in agreements between junior explorers and larger strategic or state-backed partners such as JOGMEC and SQM. Indian corporate presence in this structure remains minimal, confined largely to Vedanta's long-standing ownership of the Skorpion Zinc Mine and preliminary investment interest from Jindal Steel and Power, a gap that stands in sharp contrast to the scale of Japanese, Chinese and Australian positioning in the sector.

Downstream of extraction, Namibia's processing and beneficiation infrastructure remains comparatively underdeveloped relative to its raw mineral output, a structural weakness that is simultaneously the sector's greatest constraint and its greatest opportunity for a partner such as India. The Tsumeb smelter complex, currently transitioning through an ownership cycle from Dundee Precious Metals through IXM and Trafigura, is the country's principal copper processing facility and also processes cross-border feed from Botswana's Khoemacau copper operation. Lithium concentrate produced at Uis is currently shipped for chemical conversion at facilities outside Namibia, including a conversion plant in Abu Dhabi, illustrating the extent to which Namibia today captures extraction-stage value while ceding higher-value processing to other jurisdictions.

4. Government Priorities

The Namibian government has stated an explicit and increasingly codified ambition to move the country up the value chain from raw ore exporter to domestic processor, a policy direction reflected in the country's beneficiation-led local-content framework administered through the Ministry of Mines and Energy. A 2023 measure restricting the export of unprocessed lithium ore has, as of 2026, evolved into a more nuanced regime of exemptions and minimum-processing thresholds rather than a blanket export ban, but the policy direction toward mandatory local value addition is unambiguous and is one Indian investors should plan around rather than resist.

Namibia's 2026-27 national budget explicitly identifies mining as a key driver of growth and fiscal revenue, and non-diamond mining corporate tax receipts rose by an estimated fifty-four percent between the 2024-25 and 2025-26 fiscal years, reflecting both higher production and improved tax administration.

The government also maintains an Equitable Economic Empowerment framework, still evolving as of 2026, under which foreign investors typically structure Namibian operations through a service-and-distribution joint venture with a Namibian partner who holds local licensing and supports local-content scoring, a structure Indian companies should build into market entry planning from the outset rather than treating as an afterthought.

5. Existing Challenges

- A regulatory and permitting backlog, with over six hundred pending environmental petitions reported as of mid-2026, representing the most immediate risk to project timelines across the exploration pipeline.
- Evolving and still partially uncodified beneficiation and export-control policy, which creates a degree of regulatory uncertainty for new entrants planning integrated extraction-to-processing investments.
- High electricity and fuel costs relative to some competing mining jurisdictions, alongside water supply constraints in an arid operating environment, both of which weigh heavily on processing and smelting economics.
- A narrow domestic technical and vocational skills base for large-scale hard-rock mining, mineral processing and metallurgical engineering, requiring most operators to import significant technical expertise.
- Commodity price cyclicity, illustrated starkly by Langer Heinrich's six-year uranium-driven closure and Lepidico's 2025 liquidation, underscoring that Namibia's critical minerals opportunity, while structurally sound, carries genuine project-level and price-cycle risk.
- Intensifying competition for the same assets from Japanese (JOGMEC, Toyota Tsusho), Chinese (Xinfeng) and Australian capital, meaning Indian entrants face a narrowing window in which to secure attractive equity positions in the most advanced projects.

6. Investment Opportunities

The most compelling opportunities for Indian capital and industry lie less in competing for equity in the most advanced, already-contested rare earth and lithium assets, where Japanese and Chinese strategic capital has moved decisively, and more in three adjacent areas where India's comparative strengths are strongest.

First, mineral processing and beneficiation infrastructure, including chemical conversion, smelting and refining capacity, where India's metallurgical engineering base and existing experience operating large-scale mineral processing facilities domestically could be deployed to build Namibian downstream capacity that captures value currently exported to Abu Dhabi and other third-country processors.

Second, mining equipment, machinery and engineering services, an area where Indian heavy engineering, earthmoving equipment and mineral processing equipment manufacturers can compete on cost against European and Australian OEM incumbents, particularly if supported by structured after-sales service and local-partner arrangements of the kind the Namibian empowerment framework already anticipates.

Third, selective minority equity or offtake participation in earlier-stage exploration and development projects, particularly in copper, zinc and gold, where valuations remain more accessible than in the now sovereign-capital-contested heavy rare earth space.

7. India's Strengths

India brings a distinctive combination of strengths to Namibia's mining sector. India's own domestic mining and mineral processing industry, spanning state-owned entities and private conglomerates with deep experience in uranium, copper, zinc, bauxite and rare earth processing, gives Indian companies genuine technical credibility rather than purely financial interest. India's Non-Resident Indian and diaspora-linked mining engineering talent pool, its cost-competitive heavy engineering and capital equipment manufacturing base, and its status as a democratic, non-aligned Global South partner without the geopolitical baggage that increasingly attaches to Chinese resource investment in Africa, all position Indian companies favourably relative to competing sources of capital. India's own strategic imperative to diversify critical mineral supply chains away from near-total dependence on Chinese processing, formalised through mechanisms such as the government's critical minerals mission and public sector exploration and acquisition vehicles, provides the policy-level backing that Indian private investment in Namibian mining has so far lacked.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Joint venture mineral processing and beneficiation plants for lithium, copper and rare earth concentrates, situated in Namibia to satisfy local-content requirements while supplying Indian battery, electronics and defence manufacturing supply chains.
- Government-to-government or institution-to-institution critical minerals supply agreements, of the kind Japan has already concluded through JOGMEC, that Indian public sector mineral exploration and trading entities could replicate at Lofdal-adjacent or comparable Namibian assets.
- Technology transfer and joint research in mineral processing metallurgy, ESG-compliant mine rehabilitation, and water-efficient processing techniques suited to Namibia's arid operating environment.
- Capacity building and technical training programmes for Namibian mining engineers, geologists and metallurgists delivered through Indian technical institutions, addressing the sector's most cited structural constraint.

- Equipment supply and after-sales service partnerships between Indian heavy engineering manufacturers and Namibian mining houses, structured through local joint ventures consistent with the Equitable Economic Empowerment framework.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can establish a dedicated Mining & Critical Minerals Working Group within its proposed India-Namibia Business Council, bringing together Indian public sector exploration entities, private mining houses, and heavy engineering equipment manufacturers with the Namibia Chamber of Mines and the Ministry of Mines and Energy to identify specific beneficiation and processing joint venture opportunities before the most attractive assets are further consolidated by competing Japanese and Chinese capital.

CCI India can organise an annual India-Namibia Mining and Critical Minerals Investment Forum, timed to complement Namibia's own mining sector calendar, bringing Indian equipment manufacturers and processing technology providers into direct contact with Namibian junior explorers seeking downstream partners, and using CCI India's institutional convening power to de-risk first introductions that individual companies would find costly to arrange independently.

CCI India can facilitate financing conversations between Indian mining and metallurgical equipment exporters and Indian development finance institutions or export credit agencies, structuring blended finance packages that make Indian equipment competitive against subsidised Chinese and heavily financed Japanese alternatives.

CCI India can support policy dialogue between the Government of India and the Government of Namibia on a structured critical minerals cooperation framework, addressing the gap independent observers have noted since Prime Minister Modi's July 2025 visit, namely the absence of a concrete bilateral agreement on uranium, lithium and rare earth supply chains despite the evident strategic complementarity.

CCI India can connect Indian mining engineering colleges and vocational training institutions with Namibian technical and vocational education institutions to establish structured skill-transfer partnerships in mining engineering, geology and metallurgy, addressing Namibia's most persistent sectoral constraint while building long-term goodwill and market familiarity among the next generation of Namibian mining professionals.

10. Future Outlook

Namibia's mining sector is entering a multi-year period of genuine structural transformation, moving from a uranium-and-diamond economy toward a more diversified critical minerals producer with credible near-term rare earth and lithium production. The Lofdal project's targeted production start, Andrada's lithium concentrate expansion, and continued uranium price strength driven by global nuclear capacity additions collectively suggest mining's share of Namibian GDP and export revenue will remain elevated, and likely grow, over the remainder of this decade.

For India, the strategic window to establish a meaningful position, whether through processing infrastructure, equipment supply, technical partnership or selective equity participation, is open but narrowing as Japanese, Chinese and Australian capital continues to consolidate the most advanced assets. The chapters that follow on renewable energy, manufacturing and logistics should be read alongside this chapter, since Namibia's mining trajectory is deeply interlinked with its green hydrogen ambitions, its port and rail infrastructure investment, and its broader industrial policy of value addition, all of which present complementary entry points for Indian engagement beyond mining in the narrow sense.

2. Oil & Gas

1. Sector Overview

Namibia's offshore Orange Basin has, since the first major discoveries were announced in 2022, become one of the most closely watched frontier hydrocarbon plays in global exploration, with prospective resource estimates for the basin ranging between eleven and twenty billion barrels of oil equivalent. Major international operators including TotalEnergies, Shell, Galp Energia, QatarEnergy, Chevron and ExxonMobil have all taken acreage positions in the basin, alongside the Norwegian independent BW Energy, which operates the long-standing but only recently re-energised Kudu gas field.

For a country whose entire nominal GDP sits in the range of thirteen to fifteen billion US dollars, a commercially developed Orange Basin has the potential to be genuinely transformational, with Namibia's own investment promotion agency projecting that GDP could double by 2040 if discoveries prove commercially viable at scale.

For India, whose crude oil import dependence exceeds eighty-five percent of domestic consumption and whose energy security strategy has long prioritised diversifying supply away from concentrated Gulf and Russian sourcing, an emerging, non-OPEC, politically stable West African supply basin merits serious attention from Indian national oil companies, refiners and oilfield services providers, even though the basin's technical complexity means that the most consequential investment decisions remain several years away.

2. Current Status

The results emerging from the Orange Basin since 2022 have been genuinely mixed, a nuance any Indian entrant must appreciate rather than treat the basin as a uniform success story. TotalEnergies' Venus discovery remains the flagship find, with flow tests supporting potential production exceeding one hundred and fifty thousand barrels per day and a final investment decision targeted for 2026.

Galp Energia has proven additional oil at its Mopane discovery across a sixth successful well following five prior strikes. QatarEnergy has partnered across multiple Orange Basin blocks alongside TotalEnergies, Shell and Chevron, while Chevron and ExxonMobil have both expanded their Namibian and adjacent Walvis Basin acreage since 2024. Against this, Shell wrote down approximately four hundred million US dollars on its own Orange Basin discoveries in early 2024 after declaring them non-commercial due to poor reservoir quality and elevated development costs, and BW Energy's most recent Kudu-area appraisal well, while confirming the presence of liquid hydrocarbons for the first time, was ultimately plugged and abandoned as a data-gathering exercise, with the operator's Kudu final investment decision now pushed to late 2026, its second postponement since an original 2024 target.

The Kudu gas field itself, discovered in 1974 and now holding contingent resources estimated between one point three and over three point three trillion cubic feet, remains Namibia's designated national strategic energy project, envisioned as the anchor for an initial four hundred and twenty megawatt gas-to-power plant with potential expansion to eight hundred megawatts, sufficient to supply fifty to sixty percent of Namibia's baseload electricity needs and materially reduce the country's current dependence on imported power, which accounts for more than sixty percent of consumption, mostly sourced from South Africa. NAMCOR, Namibia's national petroleum corporation, holds its interest in Kudu in partnership with BW Energy, and the government has articulated a clear preference for using Kudu gas to meet Namibia's own energy and future green and blue hydrogen ambitions rather than prioritising cross-border export via pipeline to South Africa, a route independent studies have found only marginally viable in any case.

Indicator	Value / Status
Orange Basin prospective resources	Estimated 11-20 billion barrels of oil equivalent
TotalEnergies Venus FID target	2026
Kudu gas field contingent resources	1.3 - 3.3+ Tcf
Kudu FID target	Late 2026 (second postponement)
Kudu-to-power initial phase capacity	420 MW, scalable to 800 MW
Namibia's current electricity import dependence	Over 60 percent
Shell Orange Basin write-down (2024)	Approximately US\$ 400 million
Potential GDP impact if commercial at scale	Government projects GDP could double by 2040

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's upstream oil and gas industry is structured entirely around international operators holding Petroleum Exploration Licences in partnership with NAMCOR, which retains a mandatory state carried or working interest in most blocks and functions as Namibia's institutional counterpart for technical, commercial and regulatory engagement. Four frontier offshore basins, the Namibe, Walvis, Lüderitz and Orange, along with several onshore basins with a much longer but less commercially proven exploration history, define the country's petroleum geology. There is currently no Indian national oil company, refiner or major oilfield services provider holding acreage, a farm-in position, or a service contract anywhere in the Namibian upstream sector, representing a striking gap relative to the scale of Gulf, Chinese, European and now increasingly other Asian national oil company interest in the basin.

4. Government Priorities

The Namibian government's stated priorities for the sector centre on ensuring that hydrocarbon development translates into durable domestic value rather than a purely extractive export relationship. This includes a strong preference for domestic gas utilisation for power generation and future green and blue hydrogen production ahead of pipeline export, an insistence on local content and Namibian workforce participation in construction and operations phases, and a broader ambition to use eventual oil and gas fiscal revenue to fund infrastructure, education and economic diversification rather than allow the sector to crowd out other parts of the economy, a risk regulators and independent commentators have flagged given the scale of capital involved relative to Namibia's existing economic base.

5. Existing Challenges

- Genuine technical and reservoir complexity in the Orange Basin, evidenced by Shell's non-commercial write-down and the mixed, still-inconclusive results at Kudu after eight delineation wells over five decades, meaning basin-wide commerciality remains unproven despite headline discovery volumes.
- Extremely deep water, in places exceeding three thousand metres, which materially raises development costs and technical risk relative to shallower West African plays, narrowing the pool of operators and service providers with the capability to participate.
- Repeated final investment decision delays across both the oil (Venus) and gas (Kudu) tracks, requiring patient, long-horizon capital rather than opportunistic entry.
- An immature domestic gas commercialisation pathway, with credible studies finding pipeline export to South Africa only marginally viable, meaning bankability depends on securing a creditworthy domestic offtaker, principally NamPower, and a workable tariff structure.
- Limited domestic oilfield services, fabrication and logistics capacity, requiring almost all specialised equipment, vessels and technical personnel to be imported for the foreseeable future.

6. Investment Opportunities

The most realistic near-term entry points for Indian companies lie not in upstream exploration acreage, where competition among supermajors and national oil companies is already intense and capital requirements are prohibitive for most Indian entrants, but in the oilfield services, engineering, procurement and construction, and logistics layers that any eventual Orange Basin or Kudu development will require at scale. Indian oilfield services companies, subsea and pipeline engineering firms, and EPC contractors with deepwater or LNG-adjacent experience could position themselves as subcontractors or joint venture partners to the operators already committed to the basin, ahead of the wave of construction-phase procurement expected once Venus and Kudu reach final investment decision. Separately, Indian national oil companies and gas majors should evaluate longer-horizon farm-in or offtake discussions once basin commerciality is further de-risked through the 2026-2027 appraisal and FID cycle, positioning India as a future term buyer of Namibian LNG or crude in a manner consistent with India's broader African energy diversification strategy.

7. India's Strengths

India possesses one of the world's most extensive refining and downstream petroleum sectors, deep experience in offshore and onshore EPC execution through companies with track records in the Middle East, Africa and Southeast Asia, and a growing base of oilfield services and engineering firms capable of competing on cost against European incumbents. India's LNG import experience, developed over two decades of building import terminal and regasification infrastructure, is directly transferable to any eventual Namibian LNG export ambition, positioning Indian gas majors as natural long-term offtake partners once the basin's gas resource is de-risked. India's status as a fast-growing, long-horizon energy demand centre with limited exposure to the Namibian market to date also means Indian entry is unlikely to trigger the same geopolitical sensitivities attached to Chinese state energy investment in African hydrocarbons.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Joint venture or subcontracting arrangements between Indian oilfield services and EPC firms and the operators already committed to the Orange Basin, targeting the construction-phase procurement wave expected around the 2026-2027 FID cycle for Venus and Kudu.
- Longer-horizon government-to-government dialogue on crude and LNG offtake agreements, positioning Indian national oil companies as anchor buyers once Namibian production volumes and export logistics are confirmed.
- Technical cooperation between NAMCOR and Indian national oil companies on capacity building, regulatory design and local content policy, drawing on India's own experience developing domestic upstream and midstream regulatory frameworks.

- Indian participation in gas-to-power and associated transmission infrastructure financing, given Namibia's stated priority of using Kudu gas domestically to reduce electricity import dependence.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can convene a dedicated Oil & Gas and Energy Services delegation to Namibia timed around the Kudu and Venus FID milestones expected through 2026-2027, introducing Indian EPC and oilfield services firms directly to NAMCOR and the operating consortiums before construction-phase procurement is finalised.

CCI India can facilitate structured technical exchange between NAMCOR and Indian national oil companies on regulatory frameworks, local content design and capacity building, drawing on India's own upstream and midstream regulatory experience as a basis for institutional cooperation rather than purely commercial engagement.

CCI India can support early-stage matchmaking between Indian LNG and gas majors and Namibian counterparts on long-term offtake dialogue, ensuring Indian energy security planning incorporates Namibia as a candidate future supply source well ahead of the basin reaching full commercial maturity.

CCI India can work with Indian financial institutions and export credit agencies to structure financing packages that make Indian EPC and equipment bids competitive for Namibian gas-to-power and transmission infrastructure, an area of direct relevance to Namibia's energy security priorities and therefore of high receptivity to Indian engagement.

10. Future Outlook

The next eighteen to thirty-six months will be decisive for Namibia's oil and gas sector, with final investment decisions expected on both the Venus oil development and the Kudu gas-to-power project, and continued appraisal drilling across Galp's Mopane discovery and other Orange Basin prospects through 2026 and 2027. Should Venus and Kudu both reach positive final investment decisions, Namibia would move from a frontier exploration story to a genuine production and construction phase between 2027 and 2030, generating a multi-year wave of engineering, procurement, construction and logistics demand that Indian companies establishing relationships now would be well positioned to capture. Given the technical uncertainty that still characterises the basin, CCI India's recommended posture for Indian industry is one of active relationship-building and services-layer positioning in the near term, with upstream equity or offtake commitments reserved for once commerciality is more conclusively established.

3. Renewable Energy & Green Hydrogen

1. Sector Overview

Namibia has, over the course of this decade, positioned itself as one of the two or three most credible green hydrogen production geographies in the world, a claim substantiated not by aspiration alone but by an unusually coherent policy architecture, genuine construction-stage capital commitment, and physical resource endowment that is difficult to replicate elsewhere. Namibia's southern desert belt combines among the highest direct normal solar irradiance levels on earth with steady, complementary south-westerly coastal winds, allowing renewable projects to achieve combined solar-and-wind capacity factors that materially lower the levelised cost of green hydrogen production relative to almost any other candidate export geography. The government estimates production costs of between one dollar seventy-three cents and two dollars thirty cents per kilogram of green hydrogen, competitive with or better than most other emerging hydrogen export hubs globally.

As of 2025, Namibia hosted the only two operational green hydrogen projects on the African continent, and in May 2026 the government announced it would replace its existing Green Hydrogen Council with a broader Green Industries Council, reflecting an explicit widening of ambition from hydrogen alone to a full green industrialisation strategy encompassing green mineral processing and green manufacturing. For India, which has articulated its own National Green Hydrogen Mission and faces a structural need to secure green ammonia and green hydrogen derivatives for its own fertiliser, shipping and steel decarbonisation pathways, alongside a parallel opportunity to export renewable energy EPC, electrolyser and balance-of-plant equipment into one of the most active green hydrogen procurement markets in the world, Namibia's programme merits direct and early engagement.

2. Current Status

The flagship project anchoring Namibia's green hydrogen ambitions is Hyphen Hydrogen Energy, a joint venture between Germany's Enertrag and South Africa's Nicholas Holdings, in which the Namibian government holds a twenty-four percent equity stake through a dedicated vehicle, SDG Namibia One. Hyphen has secured forty-year land rights across roughly four thousand square kilometres within the Tsau Khaeb National Park near Lüderitz, with a further fourteen thousand square kilometres earmarked for future expansion, and is developing toward a total installed base of approximately five point two five gigawatts of renewable generation feeding three gigawatts of electrolyser capacity, targeting two million tonnes per year of renewable ammonia production across two phases at a combined capital cost of approximately nine point four billion US dollars, a sum roughly equivalent to Namibia's entire annual GDP.

Front-end engineering and design work is targeted for completion alongside a final investment decision by the end of 2026, with commercial production from the first two-gigawatt phase, costed at approximately four point four billion US dollars, expected to begin thereafter, and full phase-two output of around three hundred kilotonnes of green hydrogen equivalent per year anticipated from 2029.

Beyond Hyphen, at least seven other green hydrogen and green industrialisation projects are active in Namibia. Hylron's Oshivelo project is producing direct reduced iron using Namibia's first industrial electrolyzers, targeting fifteen thousand tonnes annually and avoiding an estimated twenty-seven thousand tonnes of CO₂ emissions per year. Zhero is developing a five-hundred-thousand-tonne-per-year green ammonia project near Walvis Bay targeting a 2026 final investment decision and 2029 start of production. The Daures Green Hydrogen Village in the Erongo region, backed by Belgian shipping group CMB.TECH and German research partners, is piloting combined hydrogen and green fertiliser production ahead of a much larger planned scale-up to one hundred and eighty thousand tonnes of hydrogen and one million tonnes of green ammonia annually.

The Cleanergy Solutions Hydrogen Dune project at Walvis Bay, backed by Namibia's own O&L Group, has inaugurated a refuelling station powered by a dedicated solar park and electrolyser. A green hydrogen locomotive pilot for Namibian Railways is also underway, positioning Namibia as home to what would be Africa's first hydrogen-powered train.

Indicator	Value
Hyphen total investment (two phases)	Approximately US\$ 9.4 billion
Hyphen renewable generation capacity	Approximately 5.25 GW (3.5 GW solar, 4.0 GW wind)
Hyphen electrolyser capacity	3 GW, targeting 2 million tonnes/year renewable ammonia
Hyphen FID target	End of 2026
Namibian government equity in Hyphen	24 percent via SDG Namibia One
Estimated green hydrogen production cost	US\$ 1.73 - 2.30 per kg
Direct jobs during construction (Hyphen)	Approximately 15,000; 3,000 permanent thereafter
National ambition (three hydrogen valleys)	Approximately 15 MTPA of green hydrogen production capacity

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's green hydrogen sector is coordinated through the Namibia Green Hydrogen Programme, housed under the National Planning Commission, working alongside a dedicated Green Hydrogen Programme office at the Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board and the newly announced Green Industries Council, giving international developers and equipment suppliers an unusually well-coordinated single institutional counterpart, a structure the sector notes is rare across African industrial markets. Project developers to date are overwhelmingly European, South African and increasingly French and Norwegian, with Enertrag, Nicholas Holdings, CMB.TECH, HDF Energy, Lhyfe and Greenstat all present in some capacity, alongside Namibia's own O&L Group as the leading domestic industrial partner. No Indian renewable energy developer, electrolyser manufacturer or EPC contractor currently holds a project position or a signed framework agreement in Namibia's hydrogen sector, representing a clear first-mover gap relative to European and other international competitors already embedded in the programme.

4. Government Priorities

The Namibian government has treated its green hydrogen ambition as a whole-of-government industrial policy priority since 2021, when it first declared its intention to become a global green hydrogen leader and signed a partnership agreement with Germany, followed by a further partnership with the European Union at COP27 in 2022. Government support has been structured around de-risking private investment through land allocation, an equity co-investment model via SDG Namibia One, a Renewable Energy Feed-in Tariff programme guaranteeing prices for renewable producers, VAT and customs duty exemptions for eligible projects, and a dedicated Infrastructure Development Fund. The government's May 2026 decision to broaden the Green Hydrogen Council into a Green Industries Council signals an explicit ambition to extend this de-risking and coordination model beyond hydrogen alone into green mineral processing and green manufacturing, directly reinforcing the beneficiation priorities described in this paper's mining chapter.

5. Existing Challenges

- Extremely large capital requirements relative to Namibia's economy, with the Hyphen project alone approaching the country's entire annual GDP in investment value, meaning bankability depends heavily on international offtake agreements, export credit support and blended concessional finance.
- An export orientation focused overwhelmingly on European offtake, particularly Rotterdam, Hamburg and Wilhelmshaven, leaving limited attention to date on Asian offtake markets including India, despite India's own decarbonisation demand for green ammonia and hydrogen derivatives.

- Significant water scarcity in the Lüderitz and southern coastal region, requiring desalination infrastructure to be built in parallel with electrolysis capacity, adding cost and complexity to project execution.
- A still-maturing domestic regulatory framework specifically for hydrogen, with the Electricity Control Board and NIPDB currently sharing oversight responsibilities pending a more dedicated hydrogen-sector regulatory structure.
- Grid integration complexity, since renewable capacity built for hydrogen projects can also feed the national grid via NamPower, requiring careful coordination between hydrogen export ambitions and Namibia's domestic electricity security priorities.

6. Investment Opportunities

India's opportunity in Namibian green hydrogen spans three distinct layers.

First, as an equipment and EPC supplier, Indian electrolyser manufacturers, solar module and wind turbine component producers, and renewable energy EPC contractors can compete for construction-phase procurement across Hyphen and the seven other active projects, an opportunity window that is most open now, ahead of Hyphen's FID and the associated wave of vendor selection expected through 2026 and 2027.

Second, as an offtake market, Indian fertiliser, shipping and steel companies pursuing decarbonisation could engage directly with Namibian developers on green ammonia and hydrogen derivative offtake agreements, diversifying Namibia's currently Europe-concentrated export orientation while securing India's own green ammonia supply.

Third, as a co-investor, Indian renewable energy developers and infrastructure funds could pursue direct equity participation in Namibia's second and third planned hydrogen valleys, positioning India alongside the European, South African and Gulf capital already active in the sector.

7. India's Strengths

India is simultaneously one of the world's largest and most cost-competitive manufacturers of solar photovoltaic modules and wind turbine components, a rapidly scaling domestic electrolyser manufacturing base under its own National Green Hydrogen Mission, and a growing offtake market for green ammonia and hydrogen derivatives in its own fertiliser and shipping decarbonisation programmes. This combination is unusual: India can approach Namibia simultaneously as an equipment supplier competing on cost against European incumbents, as a long-term offtake partner diversifying Namibia's export base, and as a policy peer with its own comparably ambitious national hydrogen mission, giving Indian delegations a basis for government-to-government technical dialogue that purely commercial European or Gulf entrants cannot as easily replicate.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Framework agreements between Indian electrolyser and renewable equipment manufacturers and Namibian project developers, positioning Indian suppliers ahead of Hyphen's and Zhero's approaching final investment decisions and associated vendor selection processes.
- Government-to-government dialogue between India's National Green Hydrogen Mission and Namibia's Green Industries Council on joint standards alignment, offtake facilitation and technical cooperation, building on the precedent of Namibia's existing German and EU partnerships.
- Direct offtake engagement between Indian fertiliser, shipping and steel companies and Namibian green ammonia developers, diversifying Namibia's export orientation toward Asian demand centres.
- Joint research and pilot collaboration on desalination-integrated electrolysis suited to Namibia's water-scarce coastal operating environment, an area where Indian desalination and water treatment expertise, discussed further in this paper's water management chapter, is directly relevant.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can lead an India-Namibia Green Hydrogen and Renewable Energy Investment Mission ahead of Hyphen's targeted end-2026 final investment decision, introducing Indian electrolyser manufacturers, EPC contractors and renewable equipment suppliers directly to the Namibia Green Hydrogen Programme office and to project developers before construction-phase vendor selection is finalised.

CCI India can facilitate a structured offtake dialogue between Indian fertiliser, shipping and steel industry associations and Namibian green ammonia developers, positioning Indian demand as a genuine diversification option alongside Namibia's currently Europe-concentrated export strategy.

CCI India can support the establishment of an institutional technical cooperation channel between India's National Green Hydrogen Mission and Namibia's Green Industries Council, covering standards alignment, certification recognition and joint pilot project development. CCI India can convene Indian renewable energy developers and infrastructure investors interested in direct equity participation in Namibia's second and third planned hydrogen valleys, providing due diligence support and institutional introductions to the Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board.

10. Future Outlook

Namibia's green hydrogen sector is approaching its most consequential inflection point to date, with Hyphen's final investment decision expected by the end of 2026 and several smaller projects, including Zhero's green ammonia development, reaching parallel decision points around the same window. Should Hyphen proceed to construction as planned, Namibia would move within a few years from a policy-led hydrogen aspirant to a genuine industrial-scale green ammonia exporter, with construction-phase procurement, desalination infrastructure, port logistics and grid integration all generating substantial parallel demand for the kind of engineering, equipment and technical services India is well positioned to supply. CCI India's assessment is that the 2026-2027 window represents the last realistic opportunity for Indian companies to establish themselves as first-mover suppliers and offtake partners in this sector before European, Gulf and other Asian capital more fully consolidates the pipeline.

4. Agriculture

1. Sector Overview

Agriculture occupies a position in Namibia's economy that is disproportionate to its modest direct GDP contribution of roughly four to seven percent, because it remains the primary or supplementary livelihood for an estimated sixty to seventy percent of the population, concentrated overwhelmingly in rural communal areas. Namibia is the most arid country in Sub-Saharan Africa, a defining constraint that has shaped an agricultural economy built around extensive livestock farming on rangeland, with crop farming, largely millet, maize and sorghum, confined mainly to the higher-rainfall northern regions along the Kunene and Okavango river basins. Livestock farming alone accounts for approximately two-thirds of total agricultural output, and Namibia has built a genuinely internationally competitive beef export industry on the back of disease-free status, rangeland-fed, largely non-genetically-modified production, becoming the first African country to gain approved access to export beef to both China and the United States, in 2019 and 2020 respectively.

For India, whose own agricultural technology sector, ranging from drought-resilient seed systems to precision and drone-based farming, has matured rapidly over the past decade, Namibia's structural need for climate resilience, irrigation efficiency, mechanisation and value-chain modernisation presents a natural and underexploited area of collaboration. This is a sector where Indian expertise can be transferred at relatively modest capital cost relative to mining or energy, while directly supporting food security and rural livelihoods for the majority of Namibia's population, giving Indian engagement here particular goodwill value alongside its commercial logic.

2. Current Status

Namibian agriculture is emerging from a genuinely difficult multi-year period. Large parts of the country experienced three consecutive dry years since 2019, forcing widespread destocking of cattle herds; between January and September 2025 alone, live cattle exports to South Africa contracted by approximately seventy-six percent as producers retained animals for breeding and herd rebuilding rather than sale. The Namibia Agriculture Union's 2026 outlook projects a modest recovery, with cattle marketing volumes expected to grow twenty to thirty percent as herds rebuild, though overall supply will likely remain constrained through the near term, and cattle prices are forecast to stay elevated across all categories. The sheep sector experienced a similarly sharp contraction, with export abattoir slaughter down over forty percent and live exports to South Africa down nearly fifty percent in 2025, though producer prices for lamb and mutton strengthened significantly, rising by twenty-three and twenty-seven percent respectively, partially offsetting lower volumes. Namibia's poultry sector, by contrast, has expanded rapidly, with broiler production up nearly fifteen percent and egg production up over six percent in 2024, and more than nine point three million chickens marketed in the first half of 2025 alone, though the country still imports roughly thirty percent of domestic poultry consumption and remains heavily dependent on imported yellow maize and soy for feed.

Namibia's grain sector remains structurally import-dependent, with import dependence projected at approximately sixty-seven percent in 2026, an improvement from seventy-three percent in 2025 following forecasts of normal to above-normal rainfall, but still reflecting limited irrigated cropping capacity and high sensitivity to rainfall variability. Government-backed irrigation expansion through the Green Scheme programme, which has established eleven irrigation projects nationwide implemented through the state-owned AgriBusDev company, represents the primary policy lever for expanding crop production, alongside a stated national ambition, cited in recent industry analysis, to increase sustainable agricultural output by thirty percent by 2026 through climate-smart technology adoption.

Indicator	Value
Agriculture's direct GDP contribution	Approximately 4-7 percent (excluding fishing)
Population dependent on agriculture	Approximately 60-70 percent
Livestock share of agricultural output	Approximately two-thirds
Cattle live exports to South Africa, Jan-Sep 2025	Contracted approximately 76 percent
Projected 2026 cattle marketing recovery	20-30 percent growth
Poultry meat import dependence (H1 2025)	Approximately 30 percent of domestic consumption

Indicator	Value
Grain import dependence (2026 projection)	Approximately 67 percent
Green Scheme irrigation projects	11 nationwide

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's agricultural industry is structured around a dual system of communal and commercial land tenure, with approximately thirty-nine percent of land under communal tenure operated by family units without formal title, and forty-three percent under commercial freehold tenure. The Meat Corporation of Namibia, Meatco, remains the dominant livestock processor, alongside private processors including Beefcor, Ohlthaver & List's Hartlief brand, and Zambezi Meat Corporation, with a newer producer-owned entrant, Savanna Beef Processors, having raised over one hundred and ninety million Namibian dollars in equity from more than six hundred and sixty Namibian cattle producers to build a new export abattoir south of Okahandja, illustrating the kind of farmer-owned value chain investment now emerging in the sector. Dairy production is dominated by Namibia Dairies' operations at the !Aimab Superfarm near Mariental, poultry by Namibia Poultry Industries and newer entrant Kadila Poultry, and regulatory oversight sits with the recently renamed Livestock and Livestock Products Board of Namibia, which now also regulates poultry, eggs, dairy, hides and skins as controlled products, alongside the Agricultural Bank of Namibia, which finances commercial and communal farmers including through its Affirmative Action Loan Scheme.

4. Government Priorities

The Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries, Water and Land Reform, led since May 2025 by Minister Inge Zaamwani, oversees a policy architecture still substantially anchored in Namibia's 2015 agriculture policy, with government priorities centred on food security, expansion of irrigated cropping through the Green Scheme, drought resilience and climate adaptation, herd and flock rebuilding following the 2019-2024 drought cycle, and biosecurity, including an Avian Influenza Master Plan under development with the Directorate of Veterinary Services and heightened border enforcement against livestock and poultry smuggling. The government has also moved to strengthen value-chain governance through the 2023 Livestock and Livestock Products Amendment Act, which broadened regulatory control to poultry, dairy, eggs, hides and skins, and continues to support the Agricultural Marketing and Trade Agency's Fresh Produce Business Hubs and National Strategic Food Reserves as instruments for stabilising domestic food supply.

5. Existing Challenges

- Chronic aridity and rainfall variability, with recurring multi-year drought cycles that force periodic destocking and constrain crop production to a narrow band of higher-rainfall northern regions, making climate resilience the sector's single most important structural challenge.
- Heavy import dependence for grain, poultry feed inputs and pork, exposing Namibia to imported food price volatility and regional supply disruptions, particularly from South Africa.
- Limited mechanisation and precision farming adoption among smallholder and communal producers, despite growing awareness of satellite monitoring, AI-based advisory and drought-resilient seed technologies among commercial operators.
- Underdeveloped cold chain and agro-processing infrastructure outside the established meat and dairy value chains, limiting value addition in horticulture and smaller livestock product categories.
- Animal health and cross-border trade friction, illustrated by South Africa's 2024 restrictions on Namibian livestock in feedlots and ongoing Foot-and-Mouth Disease risk, both of which introduce market access uncertainty for Namibian producers.
- A narrow technical and veterinary skills base relative to the sophistication required for internationally compliant export-grade meat and dairy processing, an area where technical partnership rather than purely commercial investment can add durable value.

6. Investment Opportunities

The most promising opportunities for Indian engagement lie in three areas that directly address Namibia's most acute structural constraints. First, precision and drone-based agriculture, including satellite and drone-assisted crop monitoring, targeted pesticide and fertiliser application, and drought and pest early-warning systems, an area in which Indian agri-technology companies, including drone-spraying ventures serving India's own smallholder and commercial farming base, have developed field-proven, cost-effective solutions directly transferable to Namibia's commercial farming sector and, with appropriate adaptation, to its larger communal farming population. Second, irrigation technology and equipment, spanning drip irrigation systems, solar-powered pumping and water-efficient agronomic techniques suited to Namibia's Green Scheme expansion and its broader climate adaptation agenda. Third, veterinary pharmaceuticals, animal vaccines and cold chain equipment, where India's globally competitive generic pharmaceutical and vaccine manufacturing base could directly support Namibia's livestock health infrastructure and reduce reliance on more expensive European veterinary imports.

7. India's Strengths

India brings a rare combination of relevant agricultural strengths to Namibia: deep experience managing agriculture across arid and semi-arid zones domestically, a globally competitive drought-resilient and hybrid seed development industry, one of the world's most active drone-based agricultural spraying ecosystems, a mature milk cooperative and dairy processing model directly relevant to Namibia's dairy sector development, and veterinary pharmaceutical and vaccine manufacturing capacity among the most cost-competitive in the world. India's own experience building rural agricultural extension, cooperative marketing and farmer-producer organisation models over decades of domestic agricultural development also offers a transferable institutional template for Namibia's own efforts to strengthen communal farmer organisation and market access, an area where the country's dual land tenure structure creates persistent structural disadvantage for the majority of farming households.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Deployment of Indian agricultural drone technology for crop monitoring and precision spraying among Namibia's commercial and larger communal farming operations, piloted through partnership with the Namibia National Farmers Union and the Namibia Agriculture Union.
- Joint development of drought-resilient seed varieties suited to Namibian soil and rainfall conditions, drawing on Indian seed research institutions' decades of arid-zone crop breeding experience.
- Technical partnership on irrigation efficiency and solar-powered pumping for Green Scheme expansion projects, an area that also connects directly to the water management and renewable energy chapters of this paper.
- Veterinary pharmaceutical and vaccine supply partnerships between Indian manufacturers and Namibia's Directorate of Veterinary Services, supporting the country's Avian Influenza Master Plan and broader livestock biosecurity agenda.
- Cooperative and farmer-producer organisation capacity building, drawing on India's dairy cooperative and agricultural marketing federation models to strengthen market access for Namibia's communal farming sector.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can lead a targeted Agri-Technology Mission to Namibia, bringing Indian drone-spraying, precision farming and irrigation technology companies into direct contact with the Namibia Agriculture Union, the Namibia National Farmers Union and the Ministry of Agriculture, Fisheries, Water and Land Reform, with a specific focus on solutions suited to Namibia's commercial and larger communal farming operations.

CCI India can facilitate a structured pilot partnership between Indian drought-resilient seed developers and Namibian agricultural research institutions, targeting the northern crop-growing regions where climate variability most directly threatens food security, and building an evidence base for wider commercial rollout.

CCI India can connect Indian veterinary pharmaceutical and vaccine manufacturers with Namibia's Directorate of Veterinary Services and the Livestock and Livestock Products Board of Namibia, supporting biosecurity priorities including the Avian Influenza Master Plan while opening a genuine commercial market for Indian animal health exports.

CCI India can organise study visits and institutional exchange between Indian dairy and agricultural cooperative federations and Namibian farmer organisations, transferring India's cooperative marketing and value-chain organisation model to strengthen communal farmer market access.

CCI India can support Indian irrigation equipment and solar pumping manufacturers in engaging directly with AgriBusDev and the Green Scheme programme, positioning Indian suppliers for the next phase of irrigation infrastructure expansion.

10. Future Outlook

Namibian agriculture is entering a multi-year recovery and modernisation phase following the severe 2019-2024 drought cycle, with herd rebuilding, expanding poultry production, and government-backed irrigation expansion all pointing toward gradually strengthening sector performance through the remainder of this decade, provided rainfall conditions normalise as currently forecast. The sector's structural vulnerability to climate variability, however, means that resilience-building technology and infrastructure, rather than simple production expansion, will remain the central investment theme, and this is precisely the space in which Indian agricultural technology, veterinary and irrigation expertise is best positioned to contribute. CCI India views agriculture as one of the highest-goodwill, most broadly beneficial sectors in which Indian engagement can be deepened, given its direct relevance to the livelihoods of the majority of Namibia's population and its complementarity with India's own agricultural technology export ambitions.

6. Water Management & Climate Resilience

1. Sector Overview

Water security sits at the foundation of virtually every sector examined in this paper. As the most arid country in Sub-Saharan Africa, Namibia's development trajectory, from mining and green hydrogen to agriculture and urban growth, is structurally bounded by water availability, and the frequency of droughts and floods has increased by approximately eighteen percent over the past four decades according to Namibia's own Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform. Namibian officials have increasingly framed water not merely as an environmental or utility concern but as a matter of national security; Prime Minister Elijah Ngurare, launching a major desalination project in June 2026, described water as "the currency of sovereignty," a formulation that captures the centrality of this sector to Namibia's broader economic and political stability. This is a sector, more than any other examined in this paper, where India's own five decades of experience managing water scarcity, drought and irrigation across its arid and semi-arid states offers a genuinely distinctive basis for institutional partnership.

2. Current Status

Namibia is in the midst of its largest wave of water security infrastructure investment since independence, concentrated substantially in the Erongo region, home to the country's uranium mining cluster, its principal deepwater port, and its emerging green hydrogen and industrial base. A second Erongo desalination facility, developed by China General Nuclear Power Group in partnership with the state-owned Namibia Water Corporation, targeted operational readiness by early 2027 with a capacity of twenty to twenty-five million cubic metres of desalinated water annually, positioning it as one of the largest desalination plants in southern Africa. In parallel, Prime Minister Ngurare officially launched the Erongo SUNAM Desalination project in June 2026, a two point one billion Namibian dollar public-private partnership between NamWater and Swakop Uranium, targeted for financial close in July 2026 and commercial operations by June 2028, with a further twenty million cubic metres of annual capacity dedicated to supporting mining, logistics, energy and tourism activity in the region. Both projects reflect a deliberate government strategy of using desalination to delink the country's industrial growth ambitions from an increasingly unreliable rainfall-dependent surface water base.

Beyond desalination, Windhoek's Managed Aquifer Recharge scheme, one of the most established of its kind globally, has demonstrated the value of artificial aquifer recharge as a cost-effective drought buffer for the capital, with associated agricultural applications shown to increase crop yields by up to fifty percent in some project areas by enabling farmers to irrigate more land more reliably.

Closure of Windhoek's industries due to water scarcity has been estimated to cost the economy approximately one point five million US dollars per day, illustrating starkly why water security has become a first-order economic policy priority rather than a purely environmental one.

Indicator	Value
Increase in drought/flood frequency (past 4 decades)	Approximately 18 percent
CGN/NamWater Erongo desalination plant capacity	20-25 million m ³ /year; operational by early 2027
Erongo SUNAM Desalination Plant investment	N\$ 2.1 billion (NamWater / Swakop Uranium PPP)
Erongo SUNAM plant capacity	Approximately 20 million m ³ /year
Erongo SUNAM commercial operations target	June 2028
Estimated cost of Windhoek industrial water-scarcity shutdown	Approximately US\$ 1.5 million per day
Windhoek Managed Aquifer Recharge crop yield impact	Up to 50 percent increase in project areas

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's water sector is structured around the state-owned Namibia Water Corporation, NamWater, as the principal bulk water supplier, working alongside municipal utilities, most prominently the City of Windhoek, and an increasing number of public-private partnerships with large industrial water users, particularly mining companies such as Swakop Uranium, that co-invest in desalination and water security infrastructure serving both their own operations and the broader regional grid. International engagement in the sector to date has been dominated by Chinese state capital, through China General Nuclear Power Group's desalination partnership, alongside German and other European development finance institutions supporting the Windhoek Managed Aquifer Recharge scheme and broader water security studies. No comparable Indian institutional or commercial presence currently exists in Namibia's water sector, despite India's globally recognised expertise in exactly the categories of technology, drip irrigation, managed aquifer recharge, wastewater recycling and small-scale desalination, that Namibia's own water security strategy identifies as priority adaptation measures.

4. Government Priorities

Namibia's Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform has articulated a clear, if still unevenly implemented, water security policy architecture centred on efficient water harvesting, wastewater recycling, reuse and reclamation, and continued expansion of seawater desalination capacity, priorities reiterated publicly by the Minister in the context of a National Workshop on Water Security and Climate Change.

The government's own 2025 climate resilience assessment, prepared with World Bank support, identifies water scarcity and flood hazard exposure as the primary structural risk to Namibia's resilient growth agenda, alongside agricultural resilience, sustainable tourism development and blue economy diversification, positioning water security policy explicitly as the foundation on which the country's broader climate adaptation strategy rests. Namibian officials have also acknowledged that policy implementation has been hampered by deteriorating water infrastructure, fragmented investment and limited technological advancement, creating a policy environment where technical partnership offering practical, deployable solutions is likely to receive a genuinely receptive hearing rather than encountering the bureaucratic friction more common in less urgently prioritised sectors.

5. Existing Challenges

- Structural aridity and increasingly erratic rainfall, with drought and flood frequency having risen approximately eighteen percent over four decades, placing sustained pressure on both agricultural and urban water security.
- Deteriorating water infrastructure and fragmented historical investment, acknowledged directly by the responsible Minister as undermining implementation of otherwise sound water security policy.
- Very high capital costs for large-scale desalination infrastructure, requiring public-private partnership structures and, to date, substantial Chinese state capital participation, a gap that has left limited room for alternative international partners including India.
- Competing water demand from mining, green hydrogen and urban growth, particularly concentrated in the Erongo region, requiring careful coordination between industrial and municipal water security planning.
- Limited domestic technical capacity in advanced water treatment, managed aquifer recharge and desalination plant operation and maintenance, creating an ongoing need for technical training and knowledge transfer partnerships.

6. Investment Opportunities

India's most credible entry points in Namibia's water sector lie in three areas that complement rather than directly compete with the large-scale desalination infrastructure already being built through Chinese state capital.

First, small and mid-scale desalination and water treatment technology suited to secondary towns and industrial facilities outside the major Erongo projects, an area where Indian water technology companies have developed cost-competitive solutions for India's own water-stressed states.

Second, drip irrigation and water-efficient agricultural technology, directly linked to the opportunities described in this paper's agriculture chapter, where Indian irrigation equipment manufacturers could support both Green Scheme expansion and broader on-farm water efficiency.

Third, managed aquifer recharge and wastewater recycling technical partnership, building on Namibia's own successful Windhoek Managed Aquifer Recharge experience and offering India's water management institutions a genuine opportunity for technical cooperation grounded in Namibia's own proven domestic model rather than an unproven import.

7. India's Strengths

India has developed, out of necessity across its own water-stressed states, one of the world's most extensive bases of practical experience in drought management, watershed development, drip and micro-irrigation technology, managed aquifer recharge, and increasingly, cost-competitive small and mid-scale desalination and water treatment technology. Indian institutions such as the Central Ground Water Board and state-level watershed development programmes offer transferable institutional models for community-based water security planning, while India's private sector water technology industry has demonstrated the ability to deploy solutions at a price point substantially below European alternatives, a genuinely relevant advantage given Namibia's own acknowledged infrastructure funding constraints.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Technical cooperation between India's Central Ground Water Board and Namibia's Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform on managed aquifer recharge, building directly on Windhoek's own successful scheme and Indian institutions' complementary domestic experience.
- Supply of small and mid-scale desalination and water treatment technology from Indian manufacturers for secondary towns and industrial facilities not covered by the two major Erongo desalination projects.
- Joint development of drip irrigation and water-efficient agricultural technology partnerships, coordinated with the Green Scheme expansion priorities discussed in this paper's agriculture chapter.
- Capacity building and technical training for Namibian water utility engineers and technicians in desalination plant operation, wastewater recycling and watershed management, delivered through Indian technical institutions.

- Potential Indian participation, as a co-investor or technology partner, in future public-private desalination and water infrastructure projects beyond the current Erongo-focused pipeline, particularly for Windhoek's own longer-term water augmentation plans.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can facilitate technical cooperation between India's Central Ground Water Board and Namibia's Ministry of Agriculture, Water and Land Reform, positioning India's watershed and aquifer recharge experience as a complement to Namibia's own successful Windhoek Managed Aquifer Recharge model.

CCI India can connect Indian small and mid-scale desalination and water treatment technology manufacturers with NamWater and municipal utilities in secondary towns, offering a cost-competitive alternative and complement to the large-scale Chinese-financed Erongo desalination projects.

CCI India can support capacity-building partnerships between Indian water management training institutions and Namibian utility engineers, addressing the technical capacity constraints Namibian officials have explicitly identified as hampering water security policy implementation.

CCI India can position Indian infrastructure investors and technology providers for participation in Namibia's next wave of water security infrastructure planning, particularly Windhoek's longer-term water augmentation requirements beyond the current Erongo-focused project pipeline.

10. Future Outlook

Water security will remain one of the defining constraints, and one of the most actively addressed policy priorities, in Namibia's development trajectory over the coming decade, with the current wave of Erongo desalination investment likely to be followed by further infrastructure requirements as mining, green hydrogen and urban growth continue to expand water demand. Given the scale of Chinese state capital already committed to the largest projects, CCI India's assessment is that India's most productive role lies not in competing head-on for the largest desalination contracts but in building a distinctive niche around mid-scale technology, agricultural water efficiency, and technical capacity building, areas where India's own domestic experience is most directly relevant and where Namibia has explicitly signalled unmet need.

7. Healthcare & Pharmaceuticals

1. Sector Overview

Namibia's healthcare system combines a genuinely ambitious public commitment to universal, equitable access with a persistently fragile pharmaceutical supply chain that has, as of mid-2026, deteriorated into what local commentators describe as an outright crisis. The country's health burden reflects a dual disease profile common to many middle-income African states: HIV and AIDS, tuberculosis, neonatal conditions and respiratory illness remain leading causes of premature mortality, even as non-communicable diseases including cancer, diabetes, hypertension and mental health disorders grow rapidly in prevalence. Namibia is almost entirely dependent on imported pharmaceuticals and medical devices, spending in excess of one billion Namibian dollars annually on medicinal imports even before the current crisis, with local manufacturing capacity essentially absent, a structural gap that positions India's globally dominant generic pharmaceutical and medical device industry as one of the most consequential potential partners available to Namibia's health system today.

2. Current Status

Namibia's public pharmaceutical supply chain entered a severe crisis in 2026, with the Ministry of Health and Social Services openly acknowledging in May 2026 that national pharmaceutical stock levels had fallen to approximately sixty percent, with the missing forty percent concentrated precisely in the most heavily prescribed and clinically essential categories, including treatments for hypertension, diabetes and severe asthma. Rural clinics, already disadvantaged by Namibia's vast distances and low population density, have borne the brunt of the crisis, with nurses in remote northern regions reporting multi-month waits for routine resupply of essential maternal and child health medications. The Ministry has attributed the shortages to a combination of delayed government payments to major pharmaceutical suppliers, chronic procurement planning weaknesses, inadequate storage capacity, and the absence of a centralised system for forecasting clinical supply needs across the public health network, a diagnosis consistent with an independent 2025 qualitative study that identified the same structural weaknesses from the perspective of pharmaceutical suppliers and regulators.

Namibia's own pharmaceutical market remains extremely small in global terms, with Statista projecting the total market to reach only approximately one hundred and twelve million US dollars by 2029, growing at a modest four point four percent annually, underscoring that Namibia's healthcare opportunity for India lies less in market size and more in addressing acute humanitarian and supply-security need, alongside longer-term positioning ahead of eventual local manufacturing development.

Academic analysis published in 2026 examining Namibia's Essential Medicines List found that a meaningful share of essential medicines remain unregistered on the Namibian Human Medicines Register, creating regulatory gaps that further complicate supply chain reliability even when product availability internationally is not the binding constraint.

Indicator	Value
Public pharmaceutical stock levels (May 2026)	Approximately 60 percent of required levels
Annual pharmaceutical import spend (pre-crisis baseline)	Over N\$ 1 billion; ~10% of MoHSS budget
Projected 2029 pharmaceutical market size	Approximately US\$ 112.3 million
Pharmaceutical market growth rate (2024-2029)	Approximately 4.36 percent annually
Population (2025)	Approximately 3.09 million
Life expectancy at birth	Approximately 64 years
Population under 15	37 percent

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's healthcare system is structured around a public sector serving the majority of the population through the Ministry of Health and Social Services' network of hospitals and clinics, procured centrally through the Central Medical Stores, alongside a smaller but rapidly growing urban private healthcare and clinic sector that operates with limited data integration into the public system, a fragmentation that independent researchers have identified as reinforcing inequity between urban and rural access. Namibia has no meaningful domestic pharmaceutical manufacturing base, making the entire system dependent on imports channelled through the Namibia Medicines Regulatory Council for registration and the Central Medical Stores and private distributors for procurement and last-mile delivery, a structure that offers multiple potential entry points, regulatory, distribution and eventually manufacturing, for an external partner such as India.

4. Government Priorities

Namibia's Ministry of Health and Social Services has articulated local pharmaceutical manufacturing as a stated priority under its National Medicines Policy Implementation Plan covering 2022-23 through 2026-27, explicitly identifying domestic manufacturing capacity as a viable long-term path to improving essential medicine availability.

In the immediate term, government priorities center on stabilising the current stock crisis through improved procurement planning and supplier payment discipline, alongside a longer-standing programme, supported by international partners including the US Agency for International Development and Management Sciences for Health, to strengthen medicines registration systems, quality assurance and the broader regulatory architecture administered by the Namibia Medicines Regulatory Council. Namibia has also continued to prioritise digital health tools, including electronic stock card and dispensing systems piloted with international technical support, which have demonstrated substantial reductions in patient waiting times where deployed.

5. Existing Challenges

- An acute, currently unfolding public pharmaceutical stock crisis, with national stock levels at approximately sixty percent as of May 2026 and rural clinics facing multi-month resupply delays for essential medications, representing an immediate humanitarian as well as commercial consideration for any Indian engagement.
- Complete absence of domestic pharmaceutical and medical device manufacturing capacity, leaving Namibia entirely dependent on imports and vulnerable to exactly the kind of procurement and payment disruptions currently driving the 2026 crisis.
- Fragmented public-private healthcare data systems, with limited integration between the growing urban private clinic sector and public sector supply and clinical data, undermining coordinated national health planning.
- Regulatory registration gaps on the Namibian Human Medicines Register relative to the national Essential Medicines List, creating friction even where international product availability is not the binding constraint.
- A small overall market size relative to India's typical export markets, meaning commercial engagement will likely need to be paired with development finance, humanitarian or government-to-government framing to be commercially viable at meaningful scale.

6. Investment Opportunities

The most immediate and consequential opportunity for Indian engagement is direct participation in stabilising Namibia's current essential medicines shortage, whether through structured government-to-government supply arrangements, Indian generic pharmaceutical exporters engaging directly with the Central Medical Stores, or Indian development finance-backed emergency procurement support, an intervention that would carry outsized diplomatic and goodwill value relative to its commercial scale given the acuteness of the current crisis.

Beyond the immediate crisis, longer-term opportunities include Indian pharmaceutical companies exploring local formulation or packaging investment aligned with Namibia's own stated National Medicines Policy ambition to develop domestic manufacturing capacity, medical device and diagnostics supply partnerships, and telemedicine and digital health platform deployment suited to Namibia's low-density, geographically dispersed population, an area where India's own domestic digital health infrastructure experience is directly relevant.

7. India's Strengths

India is the world's largest supplier of generic medicines by volume and a dominant global manufacturer of vaccines, medical devices and active pharmaceutical ingredients, giving Indian companies an unmatched cost and scale advantage in exactly the categories of essential medicine, antihypertensives, antidiabetics, antiretrovirals and maternal and child health products, that are most acutely short in Namibia's current crisis. India's own experience building large-scale digital health and telemedicine infrastructure to serve geographically dispersed and low-density rural populations is directly analogous to Namibia's own healthcare access challenge, and India's pharmaceutical regulatory and quality assurance institutions have decades of experience supporting exactly the kind of medicines registration and quality systems strengthening that Namibia's regulatory council is currently working to build with international partner support.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Structured government-to-government or development finance-backed emergency pharmaceutical supply arrangements to help stabilise Namibia's current essential medicines shortage, prioritising the antihypertensive, antidiabetic and maternal and child health categories identified as most acutely affected.
- Long-term supply and distribution partnerships between Indian generic pharmaceutical manufacturers and Namibia's Central Medical Stores and private distribution networks, reducing Namibia's cost of essential medicine procurement relative to current European and South African-sourced supply.
- Technical cooperation between Indian pharmaceutical regulatory bodies and the Namibia Medicines Regulatory Council on registration system strengthening and quality assurance capacity building.
- Exploration of local formulation, packaging or manufacturing investment by Indian pharmaceutical companies, aligned with Namibia's own National Medicines Policy ambition for domestic manufacturing capacity.
- Deployment of Indian telemedicine and digital health platforms adapted for Namibia's rural and remote healthcare access challenges, building on India's own experience serving dispersed rural populations.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can facilitate urgent engagement between Indian generic pharmaceutical manufacturers and Namibia's Ministry of Health and Social Services to help address the current essential medicines shortage, an intervention that would carry substantial humanitarian and diplomatic value while opening a durable long-term supply relationship.

CCI India can support technical cooperation between Indian pharmaceutical regulatory and quality assurance institutions and the Namibia Medicines Regulatory Council, contributing to the registration system strengthening that international partners are already supporting and giving Indian generic products a smoother regulatory pathway into the Namibian market.

CCI India can explore, with interested Indian pharmaceutical manufacturers, the feasibility of local formulation or packaging investment in Namibia, directly aligned with the government's own National Medicines Policy ambition for domestic manufacturing capacity.

CCI India can connect Indian telemedicine and digital health companies with the Ministry of Health and Social Services to pilot rural healthcare access solutions suited to Namibia's low population density, building on India's own extensive domestic experience in this area.

10. Future Outlook

Namibia's healthcare sector faces a genuinely urgent near-term challenge in stabilising its current pharmaceutical supply crisis, and CCI India views this as the single highest-priority, highest-goodwill opportunity for near-term Indian engagement across the entire scope of this paper, given the acuteness of unmet need and the directness with which Indian generic pharmaceutical capacity can address it. Over the medium term, as Namibia works to implement its National Medicines Policy and strengthen its regulatory and procurement systems, India has an opportunity to move from an emergency supplier to a structural long-term partner, potentially including local manufacturing investment, positioning Indian pharmaceutical and medical device companies as Namibia's primary alternative to the European and South African sourcing that currently dominates the market.

8. Education, TVET & Skill Development

1. Sector Overview

Skill development sits at the intersection of nearly every constraint identified elsewhere in this paper, from the narrow technical mining and metallurgical skills base discussed in the mining chapter to the specialised veterinary, aquaculture and green hydrogen engineering competencies required across agriculture, fisheries and renewable energy. Namibia's Vision 2030 explicitly frames the country's ambition to become an industrialised economy, and government officials increasingly describe technical and vocational education and training, commonly referred to as TVET, as lying "at the heart" of that industrialisation agenda. For India, which has built one of the world's largest vocational training ecosystems and possesses deep institutional experience in exactly the technical trades, welding, automotive engineering, mechatronics, electrical and renewable energy skills, that Namibia's own TVET reform agenda prioritises, education and skills represents a sector where Indian partnership can generate outsized long-term goodwill and commercial relationship value relative to its capital intensity.

2. Current Status

Namibia's TVET landscape comprises a mix of public, parastatal and private providers, with sixty-four institutions registered with the Namibia Training Authority as of 2023, offering programmes across a wide variety of trades and occupational levels, though enrolment capacity remains limited relative to national need, with the seven public Vocational Training Centres targeting school leavers collectively enrolling fewer than four thousand trainees. Institutions are concentrated disproportionately in the central regions of Khomas, Erongo and Otjozondjupa, leaving considerable regional imbalance in access, particularly in the country's more populous northern regions. The government has, through 2025 and into 2026, intensified TVET reform efforts, transforming institutions such as Kai//Ganaxab and the College of the Arts into fully-fledged TVET centres, securing land for a new regional training facility in Oshikoto, and explicitly aligning curriculum development with labour market needs in energy, construction and manufacturing, the sectors most central to Namibia's mining, oil and gas, and green hydrogen ambitions.

The Namibia University of Science and Technology has emerged as an important institutional anchor for skills development directly tied to Namibia's green hydrogen ambitions, leading the Innovating Green Networks through Industry and TVET Empowerment for Green Hydrogen initiative, which is developing specialised programmes in solar photovoltaic systems, water management and civil engineering, alongside preparing to launch Namibia's first Bachelor's and Honours degrees in Renewable Energy. This represents precisely the kind of curriculum-to-industry alignment that Indian technical institutions, given India's own parallel National Green Hydrogen Mission and renewable energy skilling programmes, could meaningfully support through structured academic partnership.

Indicator	Value
TVET institutions registered with NTA (2023)	64 (public, parastatal and private)
Public Vocational Training Centre enrolment capacity	Under 4,000 (7 centres)
Registered apprentices (approximate)	1,100+
New VTCs under construction/planned	4+ (Khorixas, Nkurenkuru, Keetmanshoop, Omuthiya, others)
Existing India-funded institutional presence	India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in IT (NUST); India Wing (UNAM Ongwediva)
Youth unemployment	Substantially above overall 34-35 percent rate

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's skills development system is regulated and substantially funded through the Namibia Training Authority, established under the 2008 Vocational Education and Training Act, which oversees the network of public Vocational Training Centres alongside parastatal training providers such as the Namibian Maritime and Fisheries Institute and the NamPower Training Centre, and community-based providers including the Katutura Youth Enterprise Centre and the Community Skills Development Foundation, which specifically target vulnerable and marginalised youth. The two public universities, the University of Namibia and the Namibia University of Science and Technology, sit outside the TVET system proper but increasingly intersect with it through applied degree programmes and industry-aligned research, particularly NUST's green hydrogen and renewable energy skilling initiatives. India already maintains a meaningful institutional foothold in this landscape through the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology at NUST and the India Wing at the University of Namibia's Ongwediva campus, both grant-funded legacy investments that provide a credible platform for expanded Indian engagement rather than a cold start.

4. Government Priorities

The Ministry of Education, Innovation, Youth, Sports, Arts and Culture has made TVET modernisation and expansion an explicit government priority through 2025 and 2026, with a stated focus on aligning curricula to labour market needs in energy, construction and manufacturing, expanding physical TVET infrastructure into underserved regions, and transforming existing institutions into fully-fledged technical training centres.

This agenda sits within the broader Harambee Prosperity Plan framework, under which the government has committed to constructing additional Vocational Training Centres in locations including Khorixas, Nkurenkuru and Keetmanshoop, and reflects a clear government recognition that Namibia's industrialisation ambitions across mining, energy and manufacturing cannot be realised without a substantially larger and more technically sophisticated domestic workforce than currently exists.

5. Existing Challenges

- Limited overall TVET enrolment capacity relative to Namibia's youth population and unemployment challenge, with the public Vocational Training Centre network collectively enrolling fewer than four thousand trainees against a youth unemployment rate substantially exceeding the already-high national average of thirty-four to thirty-five percent.
- Significant regional imbalance in institutional access, with training capacity concentrated in central regions, leaving Namibia's more populous northern regions comparatively underserved.
- A persistent mismatch between formal TVET and higher education graduate output and labour market needs, with World Bank-supported analysis noting that formal graduates often remain unemployed despite completing further education and must re-route through separate employment promotion programmes.
- Curriculum development that, while actively being reformed, has historically lagged the specific technical skill requirements of Namibia's fastest-growing sectors, particularly green hydrogen, advanced mining and oilfield services.
- Reliance on a relatively small number of parastatal and community-based providers to serve vulnerable and marginalised youth populations, constraining the scale at which inclusive skilling can be delivered.

6. Investment Opportunities

The most direct opportunity for Indian engagement is expanding and deepening the existing India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology and India Wing models into additional technical domains directly aligned with Namibia's stated labour market priorities, mining and metallurgical engineering, renewable energy and green hydrogen technical trades, veterinary and agricultural technical skills, and healthcare and pharmaceutical technical training, each of which connects directly to the sectoral opportunities identified elsewhere in this paper.

India's extensive network of Industrial Training Institutes and specialised technical training bodies offers a proven institutional template that could be replicated, in partnership with the Namibia Training Authority, to expand physical TVET capacity in underserved regions, while Indian curriculum development expertise, particularly in aligning vocational training to specific industrial employer needs, could directly support the government's current reform agenda.

7. India's Strengths

India operates one of the largest vocational training ecosystems in the world, spanning government Industrial Training Institutes, private skilling academies, and increasingly sophisticated public-private skilling partnerships developed under national programmes such as Skill India, with proven experience in exactly the mechatronics, welding, automotive engineering, renewable energy and technical trades that dominate Namibia's own TVET curriculum. India's existing grant-funded institutional presence at NUST and UNAM Ongwediva, combined with India's own parallel green hydrogen skilling agenda under its National Green Hydrogen Mission, gives Indian technical institutions a directly relevant, currently under-leveraged basis for expanded academic and vocational partnership with Namibia.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Expansion of the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence model to additional technical domains, including mining and metallurgical engineering, renewable energy and green hydrogen trades, and veterinary and agricultural technical skills, each directly aligned with sectoral opportunities identified elsewhere in this paper.
- Partnership between India's Industrial Training Institute network and the Namibia Training Authority to support physical TVET infrastructure expansion in underserved regions, particularly the country's populous but underserved northern areas.
- Curriculum development collaboration, drawing on India's experience aligning vocational training to specific employer and industrial needs, to support the government's current TVET reform agenda in energy, construction and manufacturing.
- Scholarship and exchange programme expansion, building on India's existing Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation programme legacy of training over a thousand Namibian officials and professionals, extended specifically toward technical and vocational trainers and instructors.
- Support for NUST's green hydrogen skilling initiative through Indian renewable energy technical institutions, given the direct relevance of India's own National Green Hydrogen Mission skilling programmes.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can work with Indian Industrial Training Institutes and technical education bodies to expand the existing India-Namibia Centre of Excellence model into mining, renewable energy and agricultural technical domains, building on a proven institutional template rather than starting a new relationship from scratch.

CCI India can facilitate a structured partnership between India's ITI network and the Namibia Training Authority to support TVET infrastructure expansion in underserved northern regions, directly addressing the regional access imbalance the government has itself identified as a priority.

CCI India can connect Indian renewable energy technical institutions with NUST's IGNITE GH2 green hydrogen skilling initiative, positioning India as a technical partner in developing the workforce Namibia's green hydrogen sector, detailed in this paper's renewable energy chapter, will require at scale.

CCI India can expand scholarship and technical exchange opportunities for Namibian TVET instructors and trainers under the framework of India's existing Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation programme, building durable institutional relationships between the next generation of Namibian technical educators and Indian training institutions.

10. Future Outlook

Namibia's skills development system is entering a genuine reform and expansion phase, with government commitment to new TVET infrastructure, curriculum modernisation, and industry-aligned training all pointing toward gradually improving capacity over the remainder of this decade, provided funding and implementation capacity keep pace with stated ambition. Given the direct linkage between skills development and virtually every other sector examined in this paper, mining, renewable energy, agriculture, healthcare and manufacturing, CCI India views education and TVET partnership not as a standalone opportunity but as connective tissue that strengthens the credibility and long-term sustainability of Indian engagement across the entire scope of this Knowledge Paper.

9. Manufacturing & Industrial Development

1. Sector Overview

Namibia's manufacturing sector remains structurally modest, constrained by a small domestic market of roughly three million people and a heavy dependence on the performance of the primary industries, mining, agriculture and fisheries, that supply its main processing subsectors. Manufacturing activity is concentrated in Windhoek's Northern, Southern, Prosperita and Lafrenz industrial areas, with beverages, grain milling and food products, meat and fish processing, textiles and clothing, packaging and plastics, cosmetics and pharmaceutical products among the most significant subsectors, supplemented by smaller light-industrial clusters in Swakopmund and Walvis Bay. Despite its limited domestic base, Namibia's membership in the Southern African Development Community, representing a combined market of over three hundred and thirty million people, and its Southern African Customs Union and prospective preferential trade arrangement with India, give export-oriented manufacturing investment in Namibia a market access rationale considerably larger than its domestic economy alone would suggest.

2. Current Status

Namibia's manufacturing sector has grown steadily but modestly, with the Bank of Namibia projecting growth of three point eight percent in 2024 and three point four percent in 2025, driven primarily by improvements in beverages and leather-related product subsectors. The government's industrial policy is in the midst of an important structural transition, replacing the country's long-standing Export Processing Zone regime, established under the 1995 EPZ Act and now expiring, with a new Special Economic Zones framework. Under the incoming SEZ regime, participating enterprises will be subject to a twenty percent corporate income tax rate, still competitive by regional standards, alongside continued capital allowance deductions and zero-rated VAT, with the same tax treatment extended to small and medium enterprises below a defined turnover threshold, a deliberate effort to broaden industrial policy benefits beyond large export manufacturers to Namibia's MSME base.

Namibia's existing industrial and business parks, managed by the Offshore Development Company, span Oshikango on the Angola border, Katima Mulilo near the Zambia and Zimbabwe borders, Katwitwi in the Kavango region, and Ondangwa in the north, alongside dedicated gemstone processing centres at Karibib and Keetmanshoop, together hosting approximately thirty operational companies from Africa, Asia, Europe and North America and demonstrating that Namibia's zone-based industrial model, while modest in scale, is functioning and capable of attracting genuine foreign manufacturing investment when the incentive structure and market access logic align.

Indicator	Value
Manufacturing sector growth (2024 / 2025)	3.8% / 3.4%
SADC market accessible via Namibia	Over 330 million people
Incoming SEZ corporate tax rate	20 percent
Existing EPZ/industrial parks operational companies	Approximately 30, across multiple continents
Key existing manufacturing subsectors	Beverages, food processing, textiles, plastics, pharmaceuticals, leather
Construction sector growth (2024 projection)	11.6 percent (recovery after negative growth since 2016)

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's industrial development strategy is coordinated by the Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, working with the Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board on investor facilitation and the Offshore Development Company on physical industrial park development and leasing. The Ministry has signalled its intention to develop sector-specific masterplans for automotive assembly, poultry processing and mineral beneficiation, the latter directly reinforcing the value-addition priorities discussed in this paper's mining chapter, alongside a broader Industrial Upgrading and Modernisation Programme aimed at improving productivity, competitiveness and MSME scale. No meaningful Indian manufacturing presence currently exists within Namibia's industrial parks or under its EPZ and forthcoming SEZ regimes, representing a clear gap relative to the European, South African and Asian manufacturers already established at Walvis Bay and the northern border parks.

4. Government Priorities

Namibia's industrial policy is oriented around structural transformation up the value chain, explicitly favouring value-added product and process development over continued raw material export, an orientation reflected across the mineral beneficiation policy discussed in this paper's mining chapter, the government's automotive and poultry masterplan ambitions, and its broader National Trade Policy and forthcoming National Export Strategy. The transition from the EPZ regime to the new Special Economic Zones framework, anchored by a National SEZ Policy, SEZ Act, SEZ Development Masterplan and a dedicated One-Stop-Shop administrative facility, reflects a government priority of broadening industrial zone participation to include Namibian SMEs on equal incentive terms with foreign investors, rather than treating industrial zones purely as foreign investment enclaves.

5. Existing Challenges

- A small domestic consumer market that necessitates an export or SADC-regional orientation for almost any manufacturing investment seeking meaningful scale.
- Vulnerability to swings in the primary industries, since food processing, meat and fish processing and mineral beneficiation subsectors depend directly on upstream agricultural and mining output that is itself subject to drought and commodity price cycles.
- Persistent structural constraints identified by Namibia's own Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade, including limited shelf space for Namibian products in local supermarkets, weak branding and marketing of domestically manufactured goods, and constrained access to affordable capital for MSME manufacturers.
- Regulatory transition risk during the shift from the EPZ to the SEZ regime, requiring new and prospective investors to navigate a changing incentive and administrative framework in the near term.
- A narrow technical and vocational skills base for advanced manufacturing, discussed further in this paper's education and skills chapter, that constrains the complexity of manufacturing activity Namibia can currently support domestically.

6. Investment Opportunities

The most promising opportunities for Indian manufacturing investment lie in export-oriented processing that leverages Namibia's SADC and emerging India-SACU trade access, particularly mineral beneficiation and metals processing directly linked to the mining chapter's findings, food and agro-processing tied to the agriculture and fisheries value chains, and light manufacturing in textiles, plastics, packaging and pharmaceuticals aligned with Namibia's own stated automotive, poultry and beneficiation masterplan priorities. India's globally competitive generic pharmaceutical manufacturing base, discussed in the healthcare chapter, could specifically explore local formulation or packaging investment under the new SEZ regime, combining humanitarian supply security benefits with a genuine commercial manufacturing footprint. Indian MSME-oriented industrial equipment and light manufacturing technology suppliers could also find a receptive market given the government's explicit MSME-inclusion priority under the incoming SEZ framework.

7. India's Strengths

India brings deep experience operating a manufacturing base for a large, price-sensitive domestic and export market, with particular strength in exactly the light manufacturing subsectors most relevant to Namibia's own priorities, textiles, plastics and packaging, pharmaceuticals, food processing equipment and automotive components.

India's decades of experience developing MSME-focused industrial policy instruments, cluster development and export processing zone frameworks offer a directly relevant institutional template as Namibia transitions to its own SEZ regime, while India's cost-competitive capital equipment manufacturing base positions Indian suppliers favourably for Namibia's industrial park tenants seeking affordable machinery.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Indian pharmaceutical, food processing and light manufacturing investment under Namibia's incoming SEZ regime, targeting SADC-wide export markets rather than the domestic market alone.
- Technical exchange between Indian MSME development institutions and Namibia's Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade on cluster development and industrial upgrading, informing implementation of Namibia's own Industrial Upgrading and Modernisation Programme.
- Supply of Indian industrial and light manufacturing equipment to tenants of Namibia's existing and planned industrial parks, positioning Indian machinery as a cost-competitive alternative to European suppliers.
- Joint development of Namibia's planned automotive, poultry and mineral beneficiation sectoral masterplans, drawing on India's own experience in automotive component manufacturing and poultry processing value chains.
- Branding, marketing and export readiness technical assistance for Namibian MSME manufacturers, addressing constraints the Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade has itself identified, drawing on India's own extensive MSME export promotion infrastructure.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can support Indian pharmaceutical, food processing and light manufacturing companies in evaluating investment opportunities under Namibia's incoming Special Economic Zones regime, connecting interested Indian investors directly with the Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade and the Offshore Development Company.

CCI India can facilitate technical exchange between Indian MSME development institutions and Namibia's industrial policy agencies, supporting implementation of the Industrial Upgrading and Modernisation Programme and offering India's own cluster development experience as a transferable model.

CCI India can connect Indian industrial equipment manufacturers with tenants and prospective tenants of Namibia's industrial parks at Oshikango, Katima Mulilo, Walvis Bay and elsewhere, positioning Indian machinery as a cost-competitive alternative for MSME-scale manufacturing operations.

CCI India can offer Indian expertise to support development of Namibia's planned automotive, poultry and mineral beneficiation sectoral masterplans, building durable institutional relationships with the Ministry of Industrialisation and Trade ahead of their finalisation.

10. Future Outlook

Namibia's manufacturing sector is entering a period of genuine institutional transition as the SEZ regime replaces the EPZ framework, creating both near-term regulatory adjustment and a longer-term opportunity for investors, including Indian companies, to shape their engagement around a modernised, MSME-inclusive industrial policy architecture. Given Namibia's small domestic market, sustained manufacturing growth will depend heavily on SADC-regional export orientation and continued value-chain linkage to the mining, agriculture and fisheries sectors examined elsewhere in this paper, meaning Indian manufacturing investment is likely to be most successful where it is deliberately designed around regional market access and vertical integration with Namibia's resource sectors rather than the domestic market in isolation.

10. ICT & Digital Economy

1. Sector Overview

Namibia's information and communications technology sector has, since 2024, become the site of India's single most visible and successful institutional export to the country: the licensing and rollout of a Unified Payments Interface-based instant payment system developed in partnership between India's National Payments Corporation of India International Payments Limited and the Bank of Namibia. This achievement, alongside the government's own newly launched National Digital Strategy 2025-2029 and National Payment System Vision and Strategy 2026-2030, positions Namibia's digital economy as the sector in this paper where Indian engagement is already most advanced and where the foundation for substantially deeper collaboration is most immediately actionable, rather than requiring relationship-building from a cold start as in most other sectors examined in this paper.

2. Current Status

Namibia became, in April 2024, the first country in the world to sign a licensing agreement to adopt India's UPI system, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Namibian President Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah jointly announcing the partnership, and the Bank of Namibia and NPCI International targeting rollout readiness ahead of the Prime Minister's July 2025 State Visit. Bank of Namibia Governor Johannes Gawaxab has described the platform as critical to achieving Namibia's vision for a modern, secure and inclusive financial infrastructure, with NPCI International's CEO framing the partnership as extending Indian fintech infrastructure to some of Namibia's most remote communities.

This landmark digital payments partnership sits within a broader and increasingly coherent national digital policy architecture: Namibia's National Digital Strategy 2025-2029, released by the Ministry of Information and Communication Technology, sets out a roadmap across digital infrastructure, digital skills, e-government, cybersecurity and digital industrialisation across agriculture, mining and tourism, while the Bank of Namibia's National Payment System Vision and Strategy 2026-2030, launched under the theme "Inclusive Payments, Shared Prosperity," specifically prioritises interoperable, user-centred payment rails as foundational infrastructure for the broader fintech ecosystem UPI now anchors.

Namibia's homegrown startup ecosystem, while still small and constrained by a domestic market of roughly three million people and limited early-stage funding availability, is showing genuine early traction, with the country's most funded startups, including mobile payment platform PayToday, having collectively raised over eighty-eight million US dollars, and a growing number of fintech, agri-tech and education technology ventures emerging across the ecosystem. Tracxn's tracking identified twenty-eight active fintech startups in Namibia as of May 2026, an ecosystem that, while modest by regional standards, benefits directly from the payments infrastructure modernisation UPI's rollout is helping to catalyse.

Indicator	Value
UPI licensing agreement signed	April 2024 (first country globally to adopt UPI model)
UPI-Namibia rollout target	Ahead of PM Modi's July 2025 State Visit
National Digital Strategy timeframe	2025-2029
National Payment System Vision timeframe	2026-2030 ("Inclusive Payments, Shared Prosperity")
Active fintech startups tracked (May 2026)	28
Top 3 most-funded Namibian startups, combined funding	Over US\$ 88 million
Domestic market size constraint	~3 million population; most ventures require regional (SADC) strategy

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's digital economy is coordinated at the policy level by the Ministry of Information and Communication Technology and, for payments specifically, the Bank of Namibia, working in direct partnership with India's NPCI International on the UPI rollout, the most substantial and structurally significant Indian institutional presence in Namibia's digital sector to date. Namibia's private fintech and broader technology startup ecosystem remains fragmented and early-stage relative to regional hubs such as Kenya, Nigeria and South Africa, with most scalable ventures required to build SADC-regional strategies from inception given the small domestic market, and with growth-stage funding beyond seed and bootstrapped capital typically requiring South African or international sources given the relative scarcity of Namibian venture capital.

4. Government Priorities

Namibia's National Digital Strategy explicitly prioritises five pillars: digital infrastructure investment and cost reduction for connectivity, foundational and workforce digital skills development, secure and efficient e-government service delivery, cybersecurity resilience, and digital industrialisation across agriculture, mining and tourism through local app development and innovation ecosystems, all infused with an explicit ambition toward artificial intelligence readiness. The Bank of Namibia's parallel payment system strategy emphasises user-centred design, digital payment literacy, fraud detection and data-sharing mechanisms, and continued modernisation of clearing and settlement systems, treating payments infrastructure as the foundational layer without which broader fintech, e-commerce and digital wallet innovation cannot scale, a framing that gives the existing UPI partnership outsized strategic importance within Namibia's overall digital agenda.

5. Existing Challenges

- A small domestic market that constrains the scalability of Namibian digital ventures absent a deliberate SADC-regional growth strategy from inception, a structural constraint distinct from, and in addition to, funding availability.
- Limited early and growth-stage venture funding within Namibia itself, with most scaling capital sourced from South African or other international investors rather than a developed domestic venture capital ecosystem.
- A specialised digital skills gap in product management, data science and advanced software engineering, requiring most Namibian ventures to recruit talent from regional hubs rather than domestically.
- Digital infrastructure and connectivity cost barriers that the National Digital Strategy itself identifies as a foundational constraint on broader digital inclusion, particularly outside Windhoek and the main coastal towns.

- The still-early implementation stage of both the National Digital Strategy and National Payment System Vision, both launched in 2025-2026, meaning execution capacity and coordination across ministries remains to be fully proven.

6. Investment Opportunities

The most immediate and lowest-friction opportunity is deepening and expanding the existing UPI partnership, both by supporting merchant and consumer adoption following the technical rollout, and by extending the digital public infrastructure relationship into adjacent areas India has demonstrated strength in domestically, digital identity systems, account aggregator frameworks for financial data sharing, and open network-based e-commerce infrastructure, each a natural extension of the payments foundation now in place. Beyond digital public infrastructure, opportunities exist for Indian IT services and software development companies to establish a Namibian or SADC-regional delivery presence leveraging Namibia's English-language workforce and time zone alignment with Europe, for Indian cybersecurity companies to support the National Digital Strategy's explicit cybersecurity resilience pillar, and for Indian venture capital and startup ecosystem builders to help address the growth-stage funding gap Namibian founders currently face.

7. India's Strengths

India possesses arguably the most successful and comprehensively developed digital public infrastructure stack in the world, encompassing not only UPI but also digital identity, account aggregator and open commerce network frameworks collectively known as India Stack, giving Indian institutions unmatched credibility and technical depth to extend the Namibia partnership well beyond payments alone. India's status as a global IT services and software engineering hub, combined with the pre-existing India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology at the Namibia University of Science and Technology discussed in this paper's education chapter, provides both the commercial capability and the institutional relationship base to support Namibia's digital skills and digital industrialisation ambitions directly.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Deepening the UPI partnership through merchant and consumer adoption support, and exploring extension into complementary India Stack components including digital identity and account aggregator frameworks, in direct partnership with the Bank of Namibia.
- Indian IT services and software development companies establishing a Namibian or SADC-regional delivery presence, leveraging the existing India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in IT at NUST as an anchor institution.
- Indian cybersecurity companies supporting implementation of the National Digital Strategy's cybersecurity resilience pillar, an area of explicit government priority with limited current international partnership visible.

- Indian venture capital and startup ecosystem development organisations engaging with Namibia's fintech and broader technology startup community to help address the growth-stage funding gap founders currently face.
- Joint digital skills training initiatives between Indian technical education institutions and Namibia's National Digital Strategy skills pillar, building on the existing NUST partnership and addressing the specialised talent gap in product management, data science and software engineering.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can convene a structured follow-on dialogue building directly on the UPI partnership's success, bringing NPCI International, Indian digital public infrastructure institutions and the Bank of Namibia together to explore extending the relationship into digital identity and account aggregator frameworks.

CCI India can support Indian IT services and software companies in evaluating a Namibian or SADC-regional delivery presence, leveraging the existing India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in IT at NUST as an institutional anchor for talent pipeline development.

CCI India can facilitate introductions between Indian cybersecurity companies and Namibia's Ministry of Information and Communication Technology, supporting the explicit cybersecurity resilience pillar of the National Digital Strategy.

CCI India can connect Indian venture capital investors and startup ecosystem builders with Namibia's fintech and technology founder community, helping address the growth-stage funding gap that currently constrains the scaling of promising Namibian digital ventures.

10. Future Outlook

Namibia's digital economy is entering a genuinely dynamic phase, with the UPI partnership now operational, a coherent National Digital Strategy and National Payment System Vision both freshly launched, and a startup ecosystem beginning to show early commercial traction. Given that India already holds the most visible and successful institutional partnership position in this sector of any examined in this paper, CCI India's assessment is that ICT and digital economy engagement represents the lowest-friction, highest-momentum opportunity for rapidly deepening India-Namibia commercial ties, and should serve as a reference model, in terms of government-to-government coordination and follow-through, for CCI India's approach to the other sectors covered in this paper.

11. Logistics, Ports & Trade Facilitation

1. Sector Overview

Namibia's logistics and port infrastructure is the physical foundation underpinning nearly every sectoral opportunity examined in this paper, from mineral and hydrocarbon exports to agricultural trade and manufacturing market access, and is itself in the midst of what Namibian Ports Authority officials describe as the most significant investment pipeline in the port authority's history. Walvis Bay, Namibia's principal deepwater port, has positioned itself explicitly as an alternative gateway for Southern Africa's landlocked economies, Botswana, Zambia, Zimbabwe and the Democratic Republic of Congo, at a moment when congestion and operational difficulty at South Africa's Durban port is actively pushing regional cargo owners to diversify their logistics corridors, creating a genuinely favourable window for Walvis Bay's continued growth and for the Indian companies, exporters and logistics providers who position themselves along its corridors early.

2. Current Status

The Namibian Ports Authority, Namport, completed a major deepening of the Walvis Bay entrance channel from fourteen to sixteen point five metres in mid-2025, enabling the port to accommodate larger vessels previously routed to South Africa's eastern seaboard, while the port's New Container Terminal, built on forty hectares of reclaimed land and now operated under concession by a Mediterranean Shipping Company subsidiary, has expanded container handling capacity to approximately seven hundred and fifty thousand twenty-foot-equivalent units annually. In January 2025, Mediterranean Shipping Company, the world's largest container shipping line, designated Walvis Bay as its transshipment hub for the Southern Africa West Coast, adding direct services connecting North Europe, Namibia, South Africa and East African ports, a designation that materially raises Walvis Bay's standing in global container shipping networks. Terminal Investment Namibia has separately added six new rubber-tyred gantry cranes following a one hundred and twenty-six point five million US dollar terminal modernisation financing package, further improving productivity.

The Port of Lüderitz, historically a smaller fishing and cargo harbour, is being actively repositioned as Namibia's dedicated offshore oil and gas logistics base given its proximity to Orange Basin acreage, with a new drilling fluid supply facility, the first of its kind in Namibia, already established at Walvis Bay and further infrastructure planning under way in direct coordination with Orange Basin operators ahead of expected final investment decisions and first oil targeted for 2029. Namport has reserved land at Walvis Bay's North Port specifically for energy and industrial clusters intended to serve the wider SADC region, directly connecting the port's development trajectory to this paper's oil and gas and renewable energy chapters.

Indicator	Value
Walvis Bay entrance channel depth (post-2025 deepening)	16.5 metres (from 14 metres)
New Container Terminal capacity	Approximately 750,000 TEUs/year
MSC Southern Africa West Coast transshipment hub designation	January 2025
TIN terminal modernisation financing	US\$ 126.5 million
Trans-Kalahari Corridor length (Walvis Bay to Gaborone)	Approximately 1,900 km
Proposed Walvis Bay-Ndola-Lubumbashi rail extension	Approximately 770 km
SADC population reachable via Walvis Bay corridors	Over 330 million
Botswana beef export time to Walvis Bay vs. Durban	24 hours vs. 3-4 days

3. Industry Structure

Namibia's logistics ecosystem is anchored by Namport as port authority and landlord, Terminal Investment Namibia as the concessioned container terminal operator, and the Walvis Bay Corridor Group, a public-private partnership established in 2000 that functions as a one-stop coordination facility for the Trans-Kalahari, Trans-Cunene, Trans-Oranje and Walvis Bay-Ndola-Lubumbashi transport corridors linking Namibia to Botswana, Angola, South Africa, Zambia, Malawi and the DRC. Dry port facilities already established at Walvis Bay by Botswana, Zambia and Zimbabwe demonstrate the corridor model's proven commercial viability, while private logistics operators such as Paratus Namibia provide end-to-end customs clearance and last-mile delivery services regionally. Global shipping lines and industrial users, including Maersk, MSC, BMW and major regional retailers such as Shoprite and Pick n Pay, already utilise Walvis Bay's Special Economic Zone as a SADC distribution hub, illustrating the port's proven commercial model, one in which Indian shipping, logistics and trading companies currently have negligible visible presence relative to European, South African and Gulf competitors.

4. Government Priorities

The Namibian government's logistics strategy, reflected in Namport's own stated positioning that "Walvis Bay is not trying to be Durban or Dar es Salaam," prioritises differentiated corridor reliability over scale competition with larger regional ports, targeting a five percent annual increase in logistics sector GDP by 2027 under the Harambee Prosperity Plan. Key stated government priorities include multimodal integration to reduce current over-reliance on road transport, given that rail connectivity continues to lag freight demand, accelerated border efficiency through single-window customs systems, risk-based inspection models and twenty-four-hour border operations, and continued corridor infrastructure investment including the Trans-Kalahari Railway project linking Namibia to Botswana and prospective rail extension into Zambia's Copperbelt and the Democratic Republic of Congo. The government has also articulated a longer-term ambition to power Walvis Bay's cranes and trucks using green hydrogen produced in the ||Kharas region by 2030, directly linking the port's development trajectory to the renewable energy chapter's findings.

5. Existing Challenges

- Rail connectivity that continues to lag freight demand, forcing heavy reliance on road transport and elevating logistics costs, a constraint Namport's own commercial leadership has explicitly identified as requiring urgent multimodal investment.
- Cross-border regulatory harmonisation and border efficiency gaps across corridor partner countries, which Namport describes as a competitive imperative rather than an optional improvement.
- High logistics costs driven by fuel prices, road tolls, inefficient cargo consolidation and limited backloading opportunities on return journeys, structural cost factors that affect Namibia's regional competitiveness regardless of port-level improvements.
- Competition from parallel port upgrades under way at Maputo, Nacala, Luanda and Dar es Salaam, meaning Walvis Bay's current window of relative advantage over congested South African ports will not remain uncontested indefinitely.
- Continued dependence on the pace of Orange Basin oil and gas final investment decisions to justify the scale of logistics infrastructure investment currently being planned at Lüderitz specifically.

6. Investment Opportunities

The clearest near-term opportunity for Indian companies is establishing a visible commercial presence along Namibia's corridor ecosystem ahead of continued regional cargo diversification away from congested South African ports, whether through Indian shipping and freight forwarding companies establishing Walvis Bay operations, Indian port equipment manufacturers, quay cranes, container handling equipment, rubber-tyred gantry cranes, competing for Namport's continued modernisation programme, or Indian trading companies using Walvis Bay's Special Economic Zone as a SADC distribution base in the same manner as Shoprite, Pick n Pay and other established users. A second opportunity lies in rail and multimodal infrastructure investment or technical partnership, given the government's own explicit prioritisation of the Trans-Kalahari Railway and prospective Zambia and DRC rail extensions, areas where Indian rail engineering and rolling stock manufacturing expertise, already exported successfully to other African markets, could compete for a meaningful role.

7. India's Strengths

India operates one of the world's largest port and logistics networks domestically, with correspondingly deep experience in port equipment manufacturing, container terminal operations, customs modernisation and multimodal corridor development, all directly relevant to Namport's stated priorities. India's growing rail engineering and rolling stock export experience across Africa and Asia positions Indian companies credibly for the Trans-Kalahari and prospective Zambia rail projects, while India's own trading and shipping company base, already active across other African ports, has a natural incentive to establish Walvis Bay operations given the corridor's direct relevance to Indian trade with landlocked SADC markets and mineral-rich Zambia and the DRC in particular.

8. Potential Areas of Collaboration

- Indian shipping, freight forwarding and trading companies establishing operational presence at Walvis Bay's Special Economic Zone, positioning Indian trade flows to benefit directly from the port's corridor access to Botswana, Zambia, Zimbabwe and the DRC.
- Indian port equipment manufacturers competing for ongoing Namport modernisation contracts, including quay cranes, container handling equipment and related port machinery, as a cost-competitive alternative to established European suppliers.
- Indian rail engineering and rolling stock companies engaging with the Trans-Kalahari Railway project and prospective Walvis Bay-Ndola-Lubumbashi rail extension, building on India's export rail engineering experience elsewhere in Africa.
- Technical cooperation between Indian customs modernisation experts and the Walvis Bay Corridor Group on single-window systems and border efficiency reform, directly addressing a priority Namport has explicitly flagged.

- Indian participation in Lüderitz's development as an offshore oil and gas logistics base, coordinated with the opportunities identified in this paper's oil and gas chapter.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can facilitate introductions between Indian shipping, freight forwarding and trading companies and the Walvis Bay Corridor Group and Namport, positioning Indian trade flows to benefit from the corridor access Namibia offers into Botswana, Zambia, Zimbabwe and the DRC.

CCI India can connect Indian port equipment manufacturers with Namport's ongoing modernisation programme, offering a cost-competitive alternative to established European suppliers for quay cranes, container handling equipment and related machinery.

CCI India can support Indian rail engineering and rolling stock companies in engaging with the Trans-Kalahari Railway project and prospective Zambia and DRC rail extensions, drawing on India's rail export experience elsewhere on the continent.

CCI India can facilitate technical cooperation between Indian customs modernisation experts and the Walvis Bay Corridor Group on single-window systems and border efficiency reform, directly supporting a priority Namport's own leadership has publicly identified as a competitive imperative.

10. Future Outlook

Namibia's logistics and port sector is positioned for continued growth over the remainder of this decade, driven by the combination of regional cargo diversification away from congested South African ports, the logistics build-out required ahead of expected Orange Basin first oil in 2029, and continued corridor infrastructure investment under the Trans-Kalahari and prospective Zambia rail projects. CCI India views logistics as connective infrastructure underpinning virtually every other sector examined in this paper, meaning early Indian commercial presence at Walvis Bay would compound in value as trade volumes across mining, agriculture, oil and gas and manufacturing all continue to grow, rather than representing a standalone opportunity to be evaluated in isolation.

12. Tourism & Hospitality

1. Sector Overview and Current Status

Namibia's tourism sector, built on the exceptional scale and quality of the Namib Desert, Etosha National Park, the Skeleton Coast and Damaraland, competes deliberately on exclusivity and conservation credibility rather than visitor volume, and has recovered strongly from the pandemic era. Namibia welcomed approximately eight hundred and sixty-four thousand international visitors in 2023, an eighty-seven percent increase on 2022, with the sector contributing approximately six point nine percent of GDP and generating roughly three hundred and forty-eight million US dollars in international tourism receipts. Hotel occupancy reached record levels through 2025, hitting sixty-seven point six percent in August against a year-to-date average of fifty percent, already surpassing pre-pandemic benchmarks, with tourist spending projected to rise fifty percent year-on-year in the final quarter of 2025, driven by luxury safari, wellness and adventure tourism demand. Namibia's community conservancy model, one of the most advanced community-based natural resource management frameworks in Africa, transfers wildlife management and tourism rights to communities, creating a proven legal structure for joint ventures between foreign investors and Namibian conservancies that has already attracted international lodge investment over more than two decades.

Indicator	Value
International visitors (2023)	863,872 (up 87.4% on 2022)
Tourism contribution to GDP	Approximately 6.9 percent
International tourism receipts (2023)	Approximately US\$ 348 million
Hotel occupancy (August 2025)	67.55 percent (record level)
Tourist spending growth (Q4 2025 projection)	+50 percent year-on-year
MET concession terms	Typically 15-25 years

2. Government Priorities and Challenges

The Ministry of Environment, Forestry and Tourism manages concession rights over state land within national parks and protected areas, awarding fifteen-to-twenty-five-year concessions to qualified operators evaluated on community benefit, conservation impact and financial capacity, while a modernised e-visa and Visa-on-Arrival system, alongside a new six-month Digital Nomad Visa, was unveiled in March 2025 to ease international access. Namibia's tourism model deliberately avoids competing on volume, meaning growth will remain concentrated in premium, low-density experiences rather than mass tourism, a positioning that requires patient, quality-focused capital rather than scale-oriented investment.

Key constraints include the sector's continued dependence on European, North American and South African source markets with limited Asian visitor penetration to date, and the specialised hospitality and conservation management skills required to operate at the standard international guests expect in remote locations.

3. Opportunities and Role of CCI India

For India, whose own outbound leisure travel market is expanding rapidly and whose hospitality investment groups have shown growing interest in African luxury tourism assets, Namibia's conservancy joint venture model offers a genuine, legally proven entry route into eco-lodge and safari tourism investment, an asset class distinct from and complementary to the resource and infrastructure sectors that dominate this paper's other chapters. Opportunities extend to Indian hospitality operators and investors partnering with Namibian conservancies on eco-lodge development, Indian outbound tour operators building dedicated Namibia itineraries to capture India's own growing luxury and adventure travel demand, and Indian hospitality training institutions supporting Namibia's conservation and hospitality management skills base.

- Indian hospitality investors partnering with MET-registered conservancies on eco-lodge development, using Namibia's proven joint venture concession model.
- Indian outbound tour operators developing dedicated Namibia safari and desert-tourism itineraries targeting India's fast-growing luxury and adventure travel segment.
- Hospitality and conservation management training partnerships between Indian institutions and Namibian tourism training providers.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can connect Indian hospitality investors and outbound tour operators with the Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board and the Ministry of Environment, Forestry and Tourism to explore conservancy joint venture opportunities and direct-flight or package-tour development targeting India's growing luxury travel market.

13. India-Namibia Cooperation: A Consolidated View

The preceding chapters of this paper have examined India-Namibia collaboration sector by sector; this chapter draws the threads together into a single consolidated view of the bilateral relationship's institutional architecture, current instruments and areas of active cooperation, providing CCI India and Indian industry with a single reference point for the relationship's overall shape.

Diplomatic and Institutional Architecture

India's relationship with Namibia, rooted in India's pre-independence advocacy at the United Nations and its role in Namibia's 1990 transition, is today anchored by a resident High Commission in Windhoek, a bilateral Joint Trade Committee active since 1995, and regular Foreign Office Consultations, the fifth round of which was held in New Delhi in January 2026. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's State Visit to Namibia on 9 July 2025, the first by an Indian Prime Minister in nearly three decades, produced memoranda of understanding on health and entrepreneurship, Namibia's accession to the Global Biofuels Alliance and the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure, and the landmark UPI digital payments partnership detailed in this paper's ICT chapter.

Trade, Investment and Development Cooperation

Bilateral merchandise trade stood at approximately five hundred and sixty-eight million US dollars in 2024-25, and India is negotiating a Preferential Trade Arrangement with the Southern African Customs Union, with Namibia coordinating on the SACU side, a process whose conclusion would materially improve market access for Indian exporters across every sector examined in this paper. Cumulative Indian investment, estimated at approximately eight hundred million US dollars, remains concentrated in Vedanta's Skorpion Zinc Mine, a legacy that this paper's sectoral chapters argue should now be diversified into critical minerals processing, green hydrogen, healthcare, agriculture and logistics. India's development cooperation footprint includes over a thousand Namibian officials trained under the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation programme, the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence in Information Technology at NUST, the India Wing at UNAM's Ongwediva campus, and a longstanding Indian Air Force technical training presence supporting the Namibian Air Force.

Indicator			Value
2024-25 bilateral trade			Approximately US\$ 568 million
Cumulative Indian investment			Approximately US\$ 800 million
ITEC-trained (cumulative)	Namibian	officials	1,000+
Most recent Consultations	Foreign	Office	5th round, New Delhi, January 2026

Indicator	Value
Flagship 2025-26 achievement	UPI licensing and rollout (first country globally)

Where the Relationship Currently Falls Short

- No comprehensive bilateral framework for critical minerals supply chains exists, despite Namibia's uranium, lithium and rare earth endowment and India's strategic need to diversify away from Chinese-dominated processing, a gap independent observers noted even after the July 2025 State Visit.
- Indian investment remains concentrated in a single legacy mining asset rather than distributed across the sectoral opportunities this paper has identified in energy, healthcare, agriculture and logistics.
- The India-SACU Preferential Trade Arrangement negotiation, while active, has not yet concluded, leaving Indian exporters at a tariff disadvantage relative to competitors with existing preferential access.
- Institutional cooperation, while historically strong, has been concentrated in a small number of flagship achievements (UPI, ITEC training, the NUST Centre of Excellence) rather than a systematically resourced, sector-by-sector engagement architecture of the kind this paper's roadmap chapter proposes.

Role of CCI India

CCI India can serve as the private-sector complement to the government-to-government architecture described above, translating the goodwill of ITEC, the UPI partnership and the July 2025 State Visit into the sector-specific commercial relationships detailed throughout this paper, and advocating for the timely conclusion of the India-SACU Preferential Trade Arrangement given its direct relevance to Indian exporters across every sector examined.

14. Challenges: Reframed as Opportunity

Every sectoral chapter in this paper has identified challenges specific to that sector. This chapter draws those threads together at the national level, and, consistent with this paper's purpose, reframes each structural challenge as a specific opening for Indian industry rather than treating it as a reason for caution alone.

Economic and Fiscal Constraints

Namibia's small domestic market of roughly three million people, its widening fiscal deficit of approximately six point six percent of GDP in 2025, and its dependence on volatile Southern African Customs Union revenue transfers together mean that most large-scale investment must be export or regional-market oriented to achieve viable scale. For Indian industry, this is an argument for structuring investment around SADC-wide market access, as this paper's manufacturing and logistics chapters describe, rather than the Namibian domestic market in isolation.

Infrastructure and Skills Gaps

Rail connectivity lagging freight demand, water scarcity requiring continued desalination investment, and a narrow technical and vocational skills base across mining, healthcare, agriculture and renewable energy collectively constrain the pace at which Namibia can absorb large capital projects. Each of these gaps, detailed in this paper's logistics, water and education chapters respectively, represents a direct commercial opening for Indian equipment suppliers, technical training institutions and infrastructure financiers rather than a reason to delay engagement.

Climate Vulnerability

As the most arid country in Sub-Saharan Africa, Namibia's recurring drought cycles, illustrated starkly by the 2019-2024 livestock destocking crisis detailed in the agriculture chapter, and its exposure to worsening flood and drought frequency detailed in the water chapter, mean that climate resilience technology, drought-resistant agriculture, efficient irrigation, desalination and managed aquifer recharge, is not a peripheral concern but a central and immediate commercial opportunity for Indian arid-zone expertise.

Health and Human Development

Namibia's acute 2026 pharmaceutical stock crisis, high youth unemployment exceeding a third of the workforce, and persistent inequality, with a Gini coefficient near 0.59, together represent the paper's most human-centred challenges, and also the areas where Indian generic pharmaceutical supply, technical and vocational skilling, and labour-intensive manufacturing investment can generate the most immediate, tangible goodwill alongside commercial return.

Competitive Positioning

Across mining, green hydrogen and oil and gas specifically, Japanese, Chinese, European and Gulf capital has moved earlier and more decisively than Indian capital, meaning India's window to secure first-mover positioning in the most attractive assets is narrowing. This paper's consistent recommendation, detailed sector by sector, is that Indian industry should prioritise adjacent, underexploited entry points, processing and equipment supply rather than upstream equity, technical partnership rather than pure capital deployment, where India's comparative advantage is strongest and competition is thinnest.

- Structural economic constraints point Indian industry toward SADC-regional rather than domestic-Namibian market strategies.
- Infrastructure and skills gaps are commercial openings for Indian equipment, training and technical partnership, not merely obstacles.
- Climate vulnerability creates urgent, immediate demand for Indian arid-zone agricultural and water technology.
- Acute near-term health and human development needs offer the highest-goodwill, most immediately actionable engagement opportunities in this paper.
- Competitive lateness in upstream mining and energy equity should redirect Indian strategy toward processing, equipment and technical services layers where India's advantage is strongest.

15. Roadmap for CCI India

This paper has, sector by sector, identified specific and actionable ways CCI India can facilitate India-Namibia economic cooperation. This closing chapter consolidates those recommendations into a practical, phased implementation roadmap for CCI India's own institutional programming over the next twenty-four months.

Phase 1 (0-6 months): Institutional Foundations

- Establish an India-Namibia Business Council under CCI India, with founding sector working groups for the highest-priority areas identified in this paper: Mining & Critical Minerals, Green Hydrogen & Renewable Energy, and Healthcare & Pharmaceuticals.
- Launch an Investment Facilitation Cell within CCI India dedicated to Namibia, serving as the single point of contact for Indian companies evaluating market entry across any sector examined in this paper.
- Open direct institutional dialogue with the Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board, the Namibia Chamber of Mines, the Namibia Green Hydrogen Programme office, and the Ministry of Health and Social Services, prioritised in that order given the urgency and momentum identified in this paper's respective chapters.
- Facilitate an urgent, targeted engagement between Indian generic pharmaceutical manufacturers and Namibia's Ministry of Health and Social Services to help address the 2026 essential medicines shortage, the single most time-sensitive opportunity identified in this paper.

Phase 2 (6-12 months): Sector Working Groups and First Missions

- Convene an annual India-Namibia Trade Mission, with the first mission structured around Mining & Critical Minerals and Green Hydrogen given the 2026-2027 final investment decision windows identified in this paper's respective chapters.
- Establish additional Sector Working Groups covering Agriculture, Water Management, Education & Skills, and ICT & Digital Economy, each chaired jointly by CCI India and a relevant Indian industry association.
- Organise the first India-Namibia CEO Forum, bringing senior leadership from Indian companies across mining, pharmaceuticals, renewable energy and agri-technology into direct dialogue with their Namibian counterparts and government officials.
- Launch B2B Matchmaking programming connecting Indian equipment manufacturers, EPC contractors and technical service providers with Namibian project developers across the Orange Basin, Hyphen and other flagship projects identified in this paper.

Phase 3 (12-24 months): Deepening and Institutionalisation

- Support Skill Development Programmes expanding the India-Namibia Centre of Excellence model into mining, renewable energy and veterinary technical domains, in partnership with the Namibia Training Authority.
- Facilitate Technology Transfer and Joint Research partnerships in mineral processing, drought-resilient agriculture and managed aquifer recharge, connecting Indian research institutions with Namibian counterparts.
- Support Policy Dialogue between the Government of India and the Government of Namibia toward a structured critical minerals cooperation framework and the conclusion of the India-SACU Preferential Trade Arrangement.
- Organise recurring Trade Exhibitions and Buyer-Seller Meets in both New Delhi and Windhoek, alongside continued annual Business Delegations, establishing a durable, self-sustaining cadence of engagement beyond CCI India's initial programming.
- Evaluate the case for Startup Collaboration programming linking Indian venture capital and startup ecosystem builders with Namibia's fintech and agri-tech founder community, building on the UPI partnership's momentum.

Guiding Principles

Across all three phases, CCI India's engagement should be guided by the principles this paper has applied consistently across its sectoral analysis: prioritise sectors where Indian comparative advantage is strongest and international competition is thinnest, favour technical partnership and processing-layer participation over late entry into already-contested upstream equity, treat the current pharmaceutical and skills gaps as the highest-goodwill near-term opportunities, and build every initiative on the substantial reservoir of historical trust between India and Namibia rather than treating this as a cold-start market entry.

Conclusion

Namibia is not, by conventional measures of market size, an obvious priority for Indian commercial attention. Its population of roughly three million people, its modest thirteen-to-fifteen-billion-dollar economy, and its still-early-stage industrial base place it well below the scale of India's more established African trade partners. Yet this paper has argued, sector by sector, that Namibia's combination of exceptional political stability, globally significant critical mineral and green hydrogen potential, a strategically positioned deepwater port gateway into Southern Africa's landlocked economies, and an unusually deep reservoir of historical goodwill toward India, dating to India's advocacy for Namibian independence decades before that independence was achieved, makes it a strategic partner whose importance is measured in more than gross domestic product alone.

The analysis across mining, oil and gas, renewable energy, agriculture, fisheries, water management, healthcare, education, manufacturing, digital economy, logistics and tourism has revealed a consistent pattern: Namibia's most pressing structural needs, critical mineral beneficiation capacity, green hydrogen equipment and offtake, essential medicine supply, technical skills, climate-resilient agriculture and water technology, map with unusual precision onto India's own comparative industrial strengths. Where Japanese, Chinese, European and Gulf capital have in several sectors already moved earlier and more decisively than India, this paper has argued that India's most productive posture is not to compete head-on for the same contested upstream positions, but to build durable advantage in the processing, equipment, technical partnership and human capital layers where India's strengths are most distinctive and competition remains thinnest.

The UPI partnership stands as proof of what focused, well-executed India-Namibia collaboration can achieve: a genuine first-mover technology export that has demonstrably strengthened Namibia's financial inclusion agenda while extending India's digital diplomacy influence in the Global South. CCI India's ambition, through the Business Council, Investment Facilitation Cell, sector working groups and phased roadmap detailed in this paper, is to replicate that model of focused, government-backed, commercially substantive partnership across mining, energy, healthcare, agriculture and beyond, converting seven decades of diplomatic goodwill into a durable, mutually beneficial architecture of trade, investment and technology partnership between India and Namibia.

Forging Partnerships. Shaping Prosperity.

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